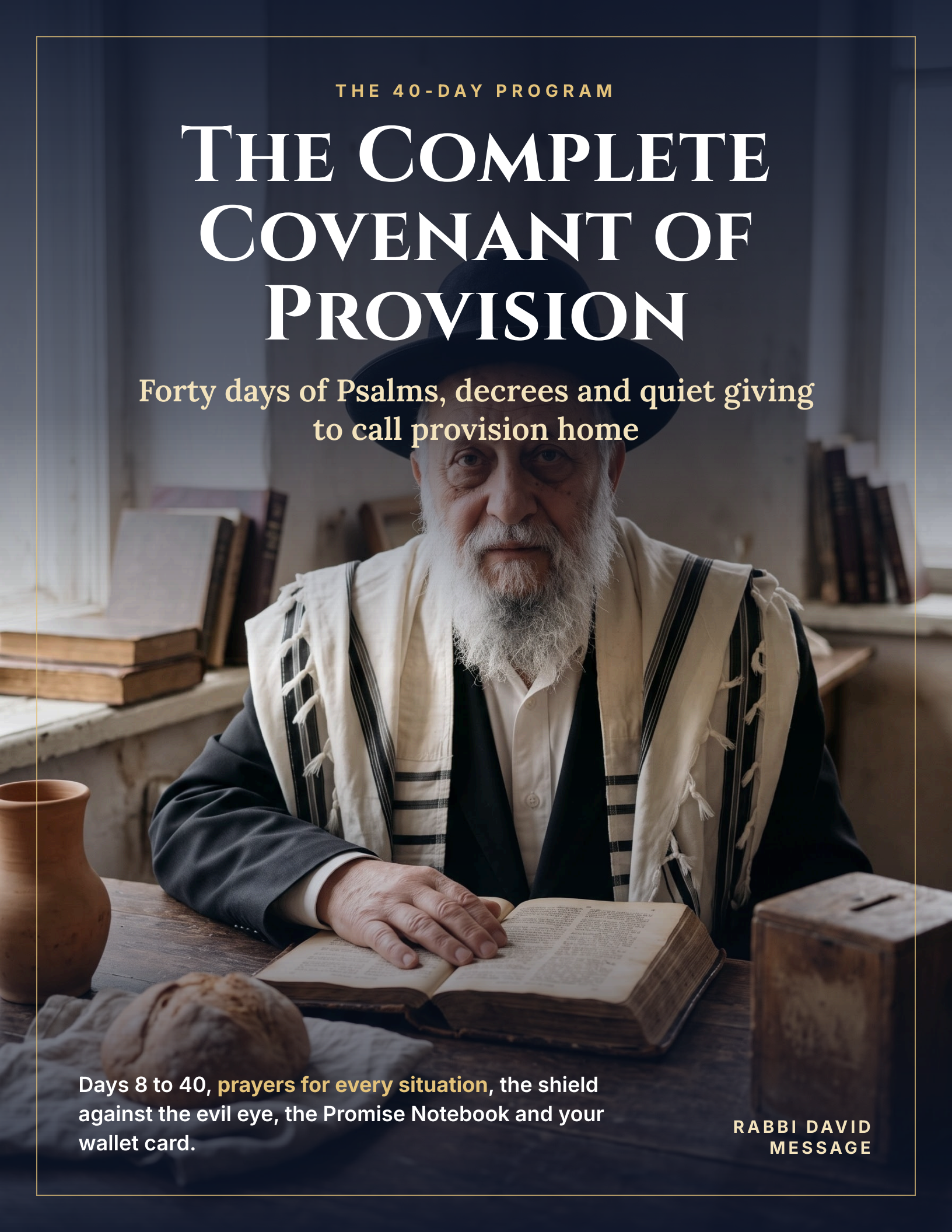
THE 40-DAY PROGRAM

The Complete Covenant of Provision

Forty days of Psalms, decrees and quiet giving to call provision home



Days 8 to 40, prayers for every situation, the shield against the evil eye, the Promise Notebook and your wallet card.

RABBI DAVID MESSAGE

The Complete Covenant of Provision

The 40-Day Program

RABBI DAVID MESSAGE

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This book is part two of the Covenant of Provision bundle. Days 1 to 7 are in Book One, “The 7-Day Command Over Money.”

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Welcome to the Forty Days

You picked up this book because something in the first seven days stayed with you. Maybe it was the morning Psalm read before you looked at your phone. Maybe it was the coin dropped into the box when your heart wanted to hold on to it. Whatever it was, you want to keep going. This book is the road ahead.

This book is for you if money keeps you up at night. If a fixed check has to stretch further every month. If there is a debt you carry, a bill you dread opening, a child or a grandchild you worry about, a house you want to keep standing. It is for anyone who reads the Bible and wants to bring those worries to Hashem in an ordered way, every day, without hurry.

Where this book begins

The program has forty days. Book A, *The 7-Day Command Over Money*, held days 1 to 7. This book holds days 8 to 40. I will not teach the first week again here. When a practice from those days comes back, I will point to it in a line, as you did in the first seven days, and we will move on.

If you have not done the first seven days, you can still begin here. But the road is smoother if you walk it from the start.

Seven minutes, three moments

Each day asks about seven minutes of you, split into three moments.

Morning, on waking, before you touch your phone or your money. This is the main reading of the day: the verse, the short teaching, the Hebrew phrase, and the decree you say out loud.

Midday, one minute. One small act that carries the morning into the middle of your day.

Night, before sleep. A line in your notebook and a few quiet words before you close your eyes.

The book suggests times, about 7:00 in the morning, 1:00 in the afternoon and 9:30 at night. They are only suggestions. Choose your own three times and keep them fixed. A fixed time does half the work for you.

What you will find at the back

At the back of the book you will find the **Promise Notebook**, pages to write each night what Hashem's word promised that day and what you saw. You will also find the **wallet card**, with one short verse in Hebrew and English. Cut it out or copy it, and keep it where your money is.

A note on the Psalms

The verse numbers in this book follow the Hebrew Bible. In some English Bibles a Psalm verse can carry a number one lower, because the Hebrew counts the heading as the first verse. If the verse you find does not match, look at the one just before it.

If you miss a day

You will miss a day. Most people do. Don't start over and don't punish yourself. Open the book at the day you left, do that day, and keep walking. Forty days done with a gap are worth far more than seven days done perfectly and then dropped.

Read slowly. Say the Hebrew out loud, even if your tongue trips. Give what you can. And let each day be the only day you have to do.

— Rabbi David



PART ONE

The Forty Days

The Torah counts its great changes in forties, and this part shows you why the program follows that count. Here you learn how each day works and begin the first two stages: the open hand of Hashem, and the bread that came down one day at a time.

CHAPTER 1

Why Forty Days

You have tried to fix money worries in one big move before. One phone call, one plan, one hard month of cutting back. And then life came in, and the worry came back. The Torah knows a slower way, and it counts it in forties.

The forty in the Torah

Open the Torah and the number forty keeps showing up at the moments when something has to change.

When the waters came in the days of Noah, the rain fell for forty days. The world that came out of the ark was not the world that went in.

> *And the rain was upon the earth forty days and forty nights. (Genesis 7:12)*

When Moses went up to receive the Torah, he stayed on the mountain forty days.

> *And Moses entered into the midst of the cloud, and went up into the mount; and Moses was in the mount forty days and forty nights. (Exodus 24:18)*

And when the first tablets were broken, he went up again, for another forty.

> *And he was there with the LORD forty days and forty nights; he did neither eat bread, nor drink water. And he wrote upon the tables the words of the covenant, the ten words. (Exodus 34:28)*

When the twelve men went to see the land Hashem had promised, they walked it for forty days before they came back with their report.

> *And they returned from spying out the land at the end of forty days. (Numbers 13:25)*

When the prophet Elijah was worn out and ready to give up, an angel fed him, and he walked on the strength of that one meal for forty days.

> *And he arose, and did eat and drink, and went in the strength of that meal forty days and forty nights unto Horeb the mount of God. (I Kings 19:8)*

And for the whole of the years in the wilderness, a people with no fields, no stores and no paychecks were fed by bread from heaven. The Torah counts that time too.

> *And the children of Israel did eat the manna forty years, until they came to a land inhabited; they did eat the manna, until they came unto the borders of the land of Canaan. (Exodus 16:35)*

אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם וְאַרְבָּעִים לָיְלָה

ar-ba-IM yom ve-ar-ba-IM LAI-lah

forty days and forty nights

Look at what these forties have in common. None of them is a reward handed out at the end. Each one is a time of preparation. The world is washed. Moses is made ready to carry the Torah down. The spies are given time to see the land with their own eyes. Elijah is carried, step by step, to the mountain where Hashem will speak to him. Israel is taught, day by day, to eat from Hashem's hand.

Forty is the Torah's number of preparation and change. That is why this program has forty days.

Why the manna fell every day

There is a question the Sages asked about the manna. Hashem could have sent a whole year of bread in one morning. Why did He send it one day at a time?

The Talmud, in tractate Yoma, page 76a, brings the answer of Rabbi Shimon bar Yochai. He compares it to a king who gives his son his allowance. If the king pays the whole year at once, the son comes to see his father once a year. So the king gives him what he needs each day, and the son comes to his father every day. In the same way, Rabbi Shimon explains, each family in the wilderness who had little ones to feed would worry: maybe tomorrow there will be no manna. And so every day, each one turned his heart to his Father in heaven.

Sit with that for a moment. The daily manna was not a sign that Hashem was stingy. It was a sign that He wanted to be near. The bread came each day so that the people would turn to Him each day.

> **WHY THE SAGES TELL IT AS A PARABLE**
> A parable lets you see yourself in the story. You are the son. The allowance is your daily bread. The visit is your prayer. The Sages do not say the son earns his allowance by visiting. They say the allowance is given in a way that brings him home.

What this means for your forty days

Here is the lesson that runs under the whole book. Provision comes daily. And so the program trains a daily turning of the heart.

You will not be asked to do something huge. You will be asked to do something small, three times a day, for forty days. In the morning you will read and speak Hashem's word before the world gets to you. At midday you will stop for one minute. At night you will write one line and lay the day down.

This is how the manna worked. Nobody in the wilderness gathered for forty years in one morning. They went out each day. Some days they surely went out tired, or afraid, or angry. They went out anyway, and the bread was there.

I want to be honest with you about what forty days can and cannot be. This book does not promise you a sum of money, and it does not promise you a date. The Torah never sold the forty that way. What the forty gave Moses was the Torah in his hands. What it gave Elijah was the strength to reach the mountain. What it gave Israel was the habit of looking up every morning.

What the forty days can give you is a heart that turns to Hashem every day about your money, instead of only on the day the bill comes. A house with order in it. A hand that knows how to open, as His hand opens. And a trust that does not have to be built from nothing each time you are afraid, because you have been building it every morning.



Forty mornings, one at a time.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

Don't count the days as a debt you owe. Count them the way Israel counted the manna, one morning's portion at a time. Today is the only day you have to gather.

CHECKLIST

- [ ] I know why the program has forty days, and not one.
- [ ] I know why the manna fell one day at a time (Yoma 76a).

- [ ] I am not waiting for a sum or a date. I am training my heart to turn daily.
- [ ] I am ready to learn how each day works.

CHAPTER 2

How the Forty Days Work

Good intentions fall apart at 7:00 in the morning, when the phone buzzes and the bank app is one tap away. A plan you can follow when you are tired is worth more than a perfect plan you follow once. This chapter gives you that plan.

The three moments

Each day of the program has three moments. Together they take about seven minutes.

Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am)

This is the heart of the day. Do it before you look at your phone, before you check your account, before you open the mail. The first thing your mind meets should be Hashem's word, not your balance.

Sit up, wash your hands if that is your custom, and open the book to the day. Read the short teaching. Read the verse in English. Then read the Hebrew phrase in the box out loud, slowly, two or three times. Then do what the box called "The order of the day" says, and say the decree out loud.

This takes about five minutes. Some mornings it will take longer because a verse holds you. Let it.

Midday (about 1:00 pm), one minute

At midday the day is at full speed. This is the moment worry likes best. So the program asks you to stop for one minute and do one small thing: say the verse again, put a coin in the box, look at one bill without fear, thank Hashem for one thing you ate.

One minute. Set a reminder if you need to. Many people tie it to lunch.

Night, before sleep (about 9:30 pm)

At night you open the Promise Notebook and write one or two lines. What did today's verse promise? What did you see today, even something small? Then you say a few quiet words and go to sleep. Each day ends with a line called **Tonight**, which tells you what to write and say.

The times in this book, 7:00, 1:00 and 9:30, are suggestions, not rules of the tradition. Choose your own three times and keep them fixed. A fixed time works like a doorpost. You pass it every day, and after a while you don't have to remember it. It remembers you.

What you need

You need very little.

CHECKLIST

- [ ] This book.
- [ ] A Psalter or a Tanakh, if you have one. It is optional; every verse you need is printed here.
- [ ] The Promise Notebook at the back of this book, or a small notebook of your own, and a pen.
- [ ] A tzedakah box, or any clean jar with a slot or a lid, kept in one place in your home.

Keep them together. A small basket by the bed or on the kitchen table is enough. When the morning comes, you should not have to search for anything.



Everything you need fits on one corner of the table.

How to read the Hebrew boxes

Every day has one Hebrew box. It has three lines.

The first line is the Hebrew itself, with its vowels, so that if you read Hebrew you can read it straight from the page.

The second line, **say**, is the sound of the Hebrew in English letters. The syllables are split with hyphens. The syllable you lean on, the stressed one, is in CAPITALS. A few letter groups need a word:

- **ch** is a sound from the throat, like the end of "Bach." It is never "ch" as in "chair."
- **tz** sounds like the "ts" at the end of "cats."
- **'** marks a short stop, a little catch in the voice.
- **Adonai** is how the holy Name is said when it is read aloud.

The third line, **means**, tells you in plain English what you are saying.

Here is an example from Psalm 145, which you will meet again on Day 8:

פּוֹתֵחַ אֶת־יָדֶךָ

po-TE-ach et ya-DE-cha

You open Your hand

Don't worry about getting it perfect. Hashem hears the heart before the accent. Say it slowly, say it out loud, and it will come.

The 40-day calendar

Here is the whole road on one page. Days 1 to 7 were in Book A. Mark each day when you finish it.

Day	Stage	Reading	Morning	Midday	Night
1	Book A: The 7-Day Command	Psalm 112	Read + decree	Book A order	Notebook line
2	Book A: The 7-Day Command	Psalm 65	Read + decree	Book A order	Notebook line
3	Book A: The 7-Day Command	Psalm 23	Read + decree	Book A order	Notebook line
4	Book A: The 7-Day Command	Psalm 91	Read + decree	Book A order	Notebook line
5	Book A: The 7-Day Command	Psalm 24	Read + decree	Book A order	Notebook line
6	Book A: The 7-Day Command	Psalm 145	Read + decree	Book A order	Notebook line
7	Book A: The 7-Day Command	Psalm 37:25	Read + decree	Book A order	Notebook line
8	I. The Open Hand	Psalm 145:15-16	Read + decree	Open your palm, repeat	Write one gift
9	I. The Open Hand	Psalm 104:27-28	Read + decree	Bless your food	Name what satisfied you
10	I. The Open Hand	Psalm 136:1, 25	Read + decree	Thank for bread	Three thanks

Day	Stage	Reading	Morning	Midday	Night
11	I. The Open Hand	Psalm 34:10-11	Read + decree	Name one lack	Write "no want"
12	I. The Open Hand	Psalm 55:23	Read + decree	Lay down one bill	Hand over the burden
13	I. The Open Hand	Psalm 37:3-5	Read + decree	Do one good	Commit tomorrow
14	I. The Open Hand	Sotah 48b, Avot 4:1, Psalm 16:5	Read + decree	Enough for today	Week review
15	II. Bread From Heaven	Exodus 16:4	Read + decree	Gather today only	Today's portion
16	II. Bread From Heaven	Exodus 16:16-18	Read + decree	No comparing	Enough line
17	II. Bread From Heaven	Exodus 16:19-20	Read + decree	Release one worry	Leave nothing over
18	II. Bread From Heaven	Exodus 16:22-26	Read + decree	Plan your rest	Prepare the Sabbath
19	II. Bread From Heaven	Exodus 16:35, Yoma 76a	Read + decree	Turn to the Father	Read the passage
20	II. Bread From Heaven	Deuteronomy 8:3	Read + decree	One word, not bread	Word that fed you
21	II. Bread From Heaven	Deuteronomy 8:17-18	Read + decree	Credit Hashem	Stage review
22	III. Guard the Gate	Genesis 49:22	Read + decree	Keep it private	Joseph's verse
23	III. Guard the Gate	Numbers 6:24-26	Read + decree	Bless one person	Priestly blessing
24	III. Guard the Gate	Psalm 121:7-8	Read + decree	Bless your going	Guard your coming
25	III. Guard the Gate	Psalm 127:1-2	Read + decree	Touch the doorpost	Rest without fear
26	III. Guard the Gate	Proverbs 13:11	Read + decree	Carry the card	Little by little
27	III. Guard the Gate	Proverbs 10:22	Read + decree	No added sorrow	Name a blessing

Day	Stage	Reading	Morning	Midday	Night
28	III. Guard the Gate	Proverbs 22:9, Avot 5:19	Read + decree	Give with good eye	Stage review
29	IV. The Work of Your Hands	Deuteronomy 28:8	Read + decree	Bless your storehouse	Write one task
30	IV. The Work of Your Hands	Deuteronomy 28:12	Read + decree	Pay one thing	Lender, not borrower
31	IV. The Work of Your Hands	Psalm 90:17	Read + decree	Bless your work	Establish my hands
32	IV. The Work of Your Hands	Psalm 128:1-2	Read + decree	Eat with thanks	Labor of my hands
33	IV. The Work of Your Hands	Genesis 39:2-3	Read + decree	Work as Joseph	Hashem was with me
34	IV. The Work of Your Hands	Malachi 3:10, Taanit 9a	Read + decree	Set the tithe	Open windows
35	IV. The Work of Your Hands	Isaiah 48:17	Read + decree	Ask the way	Stage review
36	V. The Mountain	Exodus 24:18	Read + decree	Into the cloud	Look back forty
37	V. The Mountain	I Kings 17:14-16	Read + decree	Share a little	The jar not empty
38	V. The Mountain	II Kings 4:2-6	Read + decree	What is in the house?	Count the vessels
39	V. The Mountain	Psalm 67:6-7	Read + decree	Praise aloud	Earth's increase
40	V. The Mountain	Psalm 100	Read + decree	Serve with gladness	Close the notebook



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

Put a pencil mark on this table every night. On a hard day, look at the marks behind you. They are your own small proof that you can keep going.

CHECKLIST

- ☐ I have chosen my three fixed times.
- ☐ My book, notebook, pen and tzedakah box are in one place.

- [ ] I know how to read the Hebrew box.
- [ ] I have found Day 8 on the calendar.

CHAPTER 3

Stage One: The Open Hand (Days 8–14)

When money is tight, the hand closes. You grip the wallet, you hold your breath at the register, you clutch the envelope with the bill inside. This first stage teaches you to look at another hand, the one that opens.

What this stage is for

For seven days you will read Psalms that show Hashem as the One who feeds every living thing. The goal is simple: to move your eyes from your closed hand to His open one. Each morning you will speak a verse of provision. Each midday you will do one small act of trust. By Day 14 you will have practiced, for a full week, saying "today is enough" and meaning it.



The open hand is the first lesson.

DAY 8

The Eyes of All

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

In the first seven days you read Psalm 145 whole. Today you come back to its center, two verses, and you stay there.

The Talmud, in tractate Berakhot, page 4b, teaches in the name of Rabbi Elazar that one who says this Psalm three times a day is assured a share in the World to Come. Notice what is promised: not money, but life with Hashem forever. And at the center of the Psalm stands one verse, the verse about the open hand.

That verse is so central that the Shulchan Aruch, in Orach Chayim 51:7, teaches that a person must put his mind on it when he says it. And if he said it without thinking, he goes back and says it again. The Mishnah Berurah adds that it is not enough to say the words. You have to think what you are saying.

So today, think. "The eyes of all wait for Thee." Yours too. The eyes that check the account, the eyes that read the bill, the eyes that look at the empty shelf. All of them are waiting on Him, whether they know it or not. Today you let them know it.

There is a small word in the first verse worth your attention: "in due season." Hashem gives food at its time. Not always at the time you would pick, and not always a day early so you can relax. At its time. Waiting is part of the verse. The eyes of all wait, and then the hand opens. If you are in the waiting part this morning, you are not outside the Psalm. You are standing right in the middle of it, where every living thing stands.

> *The eyes of all wait for Thee, And Thou givest them their food in due season. Thou openest Thy hand, And satisfiest every living thing with favour. (Psalm 145:15-16)*

פּוֹתֵחַ אֶת־יָדֶךָ וּמַשְׂבִּיעַ לְכָל־חַי רָצוֹן

po-TE-ach et ya-DE-cha, u-mas-BI-a le-chol chai ra-TZON

You open Your hand and satisfy every living thing with favor

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Read both verses slowly, then the Hebrew three times. On "Thou openest Thy hand," stop and think the words. If your mind wandered, say the verse again. Open your own hand on your knee, palm up, and say: "My eyes wait for You. You open Your hand, and I am satisfied." At midday, open your palm once more and repeat the decree.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

If your mind runs off in the middle of the verse, don't scold yourself. The Shulchan Aruch already told you what to do: go back and say it again. That is the whole practice.

Tonight: *In the Promise Notebook, write "Thou openest Thy hand" and under it one thing you received today, however small. Say the verse once before you sleep.*

DAY 9

They Gather It

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

Psalm 104 is a long song about creation. It walks through the mountains, the springs, the birds, the lions hunting at night, the ships on the sea. And then it stops and says something about all of it.

Every creature in that Psalm waits on Hashem. And notice the order of the next verse. He gives, and they gather. He opens His hand, and they are satisfied. The gift comes first. The gathering comes second.

That is good news for a tired person. You do have a part: you gather. You go to work if you can, you cash the check, you shop with care. But you do not make the bread. You pick up what He has already given. The lion in the Psalm hunts, and still the Psalm says its food comes from Hashem.

So today your work changes its name. It is not "making ends meet." It is gathering what He gives.

There is also comfort in the word "all." All of them wait for Thee. The great beasts and the small ones, the young and the old. Nobody in this Psalm is too small to be fed, and nobody is too strong to need feeding. You may feel you have less strength to gather than you once did. The Psalm does not measure the gatherer. It measures the hand that gives, and that hand is open. Gather what you can today, and let Him supply what your hands cannot reach.

> *All of them wait for Thee, That Thou mayest give them their food in due season. Thou givest it unto them, they gather it; Thou openest Thy hand, they are satisfied with good. (Psalm 104:27-28)*

תִּפְתַּח יָדֶךָ יְשַׂבְּעוּן טוֹב

tif-TACH yad-CHA yis-be-UN tov

You open Your hand, they are satisfied with good

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Read the two verses, then the Hebrew three times. Think of one task in front of you today, and call it gathering. Say: "You give, and I gather. You open Your hand, and I am satisfied with good." At midday, before you eat, say a blessing over your food and thank Him by name.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

Gathering is not the same as grabbing. Do your work today at an honest pace, and when it is done, let it be done. What He gives, you will find.

Tonight: *Write in the notebook one thing that satisfied you today, a meal, a call, a quiet hour. Then say "satisfied with good," yis-be-UN tov, and lay the day down.*

DAY 10

Bread to All Flesh

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

Psalm 136 has one line that comes back again and again: "For His mercy endureth for ever." It begins with thanks, and it goes through creation and through the story of Israel, and after every line, the same answer returns.

Near the end, after the great things, the sea split, the kings defeated, the land given, the Psalm says something very plain. He gives bread to all flesh. The same mercy that split the sea puts bread on your table.

There is a reason gratitude comes first in this stage. A worried heart counts what is missing. A grateful heart counts what is there. Both are counting. Today you practice the second kind. You do not pretend the bills are not there. You simply notice that bread came today too, and that it came from the same hand.

This is also why the first verse of the Psalm says "for He is good" before it says anything else. The thanks is not for what He did. It is first for who He is. When the money is short, you may not feel like thanking Him for what you have. You can still thank Him for being good. Start there this morning. The rest of the list will come as you go, one plain thing at a time, the way the Psalm itself walks from the heavens down to a piece of bread.

> *O give thanks unto the LORD, for He is good, For His mercy endureth for ever. (Psalm 136:1)*

> *Who giveth food to all flesh, For His mercy endureth for ever. (Psalm 136:25)*

נֹתֵן לֶחֶם לְכָל־בָּשָׂר כִּי לְעוֹלָם חַסְדּוֹ

no-TEN LE-chem le-chol ba-SAR, ki le-o-LAM chas-DO

He gives bread to all flesh, for His mercy is forever

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Read both verses, then the Hebrew three times. Name out loud three things you have this morning: a roof, a bed, a cup of water. After each one, say: "For His mercy endureth for ever." At midday, hold your bread or your meal for a moment and say: "Who giveth food to all flesh."



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

Thanks is not a feeling you wait for. It is a sentence you say. Say it first, and the feeling will often follow. If three things feel hard to find, start with your breath. You woke up this morning. That is the first thing on the list.

Tonight: *Write three thanks in the notebook, each one ending with "His mercy endures." Say Psalm 136:1 as you turn out the light.*

DAY 11

No Want

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

Psalm 34 makes a bold claim. Those who fear the LORD have no want. And then it gives a picture. The young lions, strong and fast, the very image of a creature that can take care of itself, go hungry. But those who seek Hashem do not lack any good thing.

The strong are not always fed. The seekers are. That turns the world's order around. The world says the young and the quick will have enough. The Psalm says the ones who seek Him will.

What does "no want" mean when your account is low? Read it closely: "any good thing." Not every thing. Every good thing. Hashem knows what is good for you better than your wish list does. Today you hand Him the list and let Him sort it.

And look at who the Psalm is talking to: "ye His holy ones." Not the rich, not the clever, not the ones with a pension and a paid-off house. The holy ones are simply those who fear Him and seek Him. That can be you, this morning, in your kitchen. To seek Him is something you are already doing by opening this book. The verse makes a promise to the seeker, not to the one who has already found everything. Keep seeking, and the promise keeps its hold on you.

> *O fear the LORD, ye His holy ones; For there is no want to them that fear Him. The young lions do lack, and suffer hunger; But they that seek the LORD want not any good thing. (Psalm 34:10-11)*

וְדֹרְשֵׁי יְהוָה לֹא־יַחְסְרוּ כָל־טוֹב

ve-dor-SHEI Adonai lo yach-se-RU chol TOV

those who seek the LORD will not lack any good thing

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Read both verses, then the Hebrew three times. Name one thing you lack right now, out loud, plainly. Then say: "I seek You, Hashem. I will not lack any good thing. You know what is good." At midday, name that lack once more and say the Hebrew line.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

Naming a lack out loud is not a lack of faith. It is how a child talks to a father. Say it plainly, and then leave it in His hands for the day.

Tonight: *Write "no want to them that fear Him" in the notebook. Under it, write the lack you named this morning, and beside it: "In His hands."*

DAY 12

Cast Your Burden

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

Some burdens have an envelope and a due date. Psalm 55 was written by a man under heavy pressure, betrayed by a friend, surrounded by trouble. In the middle of it he turns and gives an order to himself and to us: cast your burden on the LORD.

The Hebrew word for burden here, *yehav*, means what has been given to you, your load, your lot. And the promise that follows is *yechalkelecha*, He will sustain you, He will provide for you. You throw the load on Him, and He carries you.

To cast is a strong word. Not to place gently. Not to share a little. To throw. Today you will practice throwing a burden you have been holding in both arms.

Notice the second half of the verse too: "He will never suffer the righteous to be moved." To be moved is to slip, to lose your footing, to fall. Money trouble can feel exactly like that, the ground going out from under you. The promise is not that the ground will never shake. It is that you will not be moved off it. You can feel the shaking and still stand. When you cast your burden, you have two free hands again, and a person with free hands keeps his balance better.

> *Cast thy burden upon the LORD, and He will sustain thee; He will never suffer the righteous to be moved. (Psalm 55:23)*

הַשְׁלֵךְ עַל־יְהוָה יְהָבְךָ וְהוּא יְכַלְכְּלֶךָ

hash-LECH al Adonai ye-hav-CHA, ve-HU ye-chal-ke-LE-cha

cast your burden on the LORD, and He will sustain you

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Read the verse, then the Hebrew three times. Take one bill or one worry written on a slip of paper, and hold it in your hands. Say: "Hashem, this is my burden. I cast it on You. You will sustain me." At midday, lay that bill or paper down under the book, and leave it there.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

Casting your burden does not mean you stop paying the bill. It means you stop carrying it alone. Pay what you can, and let Him hold the rest. Keep the bill under the book for the rest of this stage. Each morning you open the book, you will see that it is lying under His word now.

Tonight: *Write in the notebook the burden you cast today, then cross it out with one line and write beside it: "He will sustain me."*

DAY 13

Commit Your Way

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

Psalm 37 is the Psalm you closed the first week with: "I have been young, and now am old." Today you go back to its beginning, three verses that give you a whole way of living.

Look at the verbs. Trust. Do good. Dwell. Cherish faithfulness. Delight. Commit. Trust again. There is a lot of doing in these verses, but all of it points to Him. And the last words of verse 5 tell you who does the final work: "He will bring it to pass."

The Hebrew for "commit," *gol*, means to roll. Picture a heavy stone you cannot lift. You can't carry it, but you can roll it, a little at a time, onto Someone stronger. Today you roll your way, your plans, your next steps, onto Hashem. And while you trust, you do good. Trust is not sitting still.

Look also at verse 4: "Delight thyself in the LORD; and He shall give thee the petitions of thy heart." The order matters. First the delight, then the petitions. When your heart is glad in Hashem, your petitions start to change. You still ask for the rent and the repair. But you ask as someone who is already glad, not as someone begging at a closed door. A glad heart asks better. And the Psalm promises that the One who is your delight hears what that heart asks.

> *Trust in the LORD, and do good; dwell in the land, and cherish faithfulness. So shalt thou delight thyself in the LORD; and He shall give thee the petitions of thy heart. Commit thy way unto the LORD; trust also in Him, and He will bring it to pass. (Psalm 37:3-5)*

גּוֹל עַל־יְהוָה דַּרְכֶּךָ וּבְטַח עָלָיו וְהוּא יַעֲשֶׂה

gol al Adonai dar-KE-cha, u-ve-TACH a-LAV, ve-HU ya-a-SEH

roll your way onto the LORD, trust in Him, and He will do it

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Read the three verses, then the Hebrew three times. Name one plan or decision about money that is in front of you. Say: "I roll my way onto You. I trust You. You will bring it to pass." At midday, do one good thing for someone, small and quiet: a call, a kind word, a coin in the box.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

Pick one good deed and do it before lunch. Trust grows faster in a person who is busy doing good than in one who sits and waits.

Tonight: *Write tomorrow's one most important task in the notebook, and under it: "Commit thy way unto the LORD." Say verse 5 before you sleep.*

DAY 14

Bread in the Basket

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

Today brings no new Psalm of provision. Today you look back at the week, with two teachings of the Sages and one short verse.

The Talmud, in tractate Sotah, page 48b, brings the words of Rabbi Eliezer the Great: a person who has bread in his basket today and asks, "What will I eat tomorrow?" is among those of little faith. That is a hard word, and it is meant to be. Look in your basket this morning. Is there bread for today? Then today, the question about tomorrow can wait.

And in Pirkei Avot, chapter 4, Ben Zoma asks: who is rich? And he answers: the one who is glad with his portion. He brings a verse for it, from Psalm 128: "When thou eatest the labour of thy hands, Happy shalt thou be, and it shall be well with thee." Riches, Ben Zoma says, begin as gladness, not as a number.

Psalm 16 puts the two together. Hashem Himself is the portion. He holds your lot.

This is a day to rest a little in what you have done. Seven days you have said His word over your money. You have opened your hand, gathered, given thanks, named a lack, cast a burden and rolled a plan onto Him. That is a portion too. Be glad with it, as Ben Zoma teaches. Do not grade yourself on the days you rushed or forgot. Look at the days you came. The son in the parable did not earn the king's love by perfect visits. He simply came.

> *O LORD, the portion of mine inheritance and of my cup, Thou maintainest my lot. (Psalm 16:5)*

יְהוָה מְנָת־חֶלְקִי וְכוֹסִי אַתָּה תּוֹמִיךְ גּוֹרָלִי

Adonai me-NAT chel-KI ve-cho-SI, a-TAH to-MICH go-ra-LI

LORD, my portion and my cup, You hold my lot

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Read the verse, then the Hebrew three times. Look at what you have for today: food, a roof, the next hour. Say: "Today there is bread in my basket. You are my portion, and You hold my lot." At midday, when the worry about tomorrow comes, answer it out loud: "Enough for today."



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

The question about tomorrow is not forbidden. It just isn't today's question. Answer today, and tomorrow will have its own bread.

Tonight: *Read back the six notebook entries of this week. Under them, write one line about your portion: what you were glad for. Say Psalm 16:5 as you close the notebook.*

BEFORE THE NEXT STAGE

- [ ] I said Psalm 145:16 with my mind on the words.
- [ ] I practiced calling my work "gathering."
- [ ] I said thanks out loud, three things at a time.
- [ ] I cast one burden and rolled one plan onto Hashem.
- [ ] I answered tomorrow's worry with "enough for today."
- [ ] My notebook has a line for each day of this stage.

CHAPTER 4

Stage Two: Bread From Heaven (Days 15–21)

Most money fear is not about today. It is about next month, next year, the day the check doesn't come. The manna was Hashem's school for exactly that fear, and for seven days you will sit in it.

What this stage is for

This week you read the story of the manna, the bread that came down every morning for forty years. The Sages saw it as more than history. The Shulchan Aruch, in Orach Chayim 1:5, teaches that it is good to say the passage of the manna every day. And the Mishnah Berurah, on that law, explains why: so that a person will believe that all his sustenance comes to him by Hashem's own care, and that pushing harder than he needs to adds nothing, because "he that gathered much had nothing over, and he that gathered little had no lack." The Mishnah Berurah, quoting the Jerusalem Talmud, teaches that one who says the passage of the manna is assured that his sustenance will not be diminished. He adds that it may be said even on Shabbat.

The whole passage is Exodus 16:4-36. This week you read it in pieces, one teaching a day. On Day 19, or on Day 21 if you prefer, read the whole passage through, start to finish, from your Tanakh or from the back of this book.



Bread for today, from His hand.

DAY 15

Bread From Heaven

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

The people had left Egypt and were in the wilderness, hungry, and they complained. And Hashem did not answer with anger. He answered with bread.

But look at the instructions. The people would go out each day and gather a day's portion every day. In Hebrew, *devar yom beyomo*, the thing of a day in its day. Not a week's worth. Not a year's worth. One day.

And the verse tells you why. "That I may prove them." The daily bread was a test, and also a teacher. Would they trust that tomorrow's bread would come tomorrow? That is the same test you face every time you lie awake doing sums for next month. Today you begin to practice the manna way: gather today, for today.

Notice too that the bread came down where the people already were. They did not have to travel to Egypt for it, or climb a mountain, or find a market. It fell around the camp. Hashem's provision for you today will most likely come in plain places: your mailbox, your kitchen, a phone call, the work in front of you. Keep your eyes open for it there. The manna was small and white and lay on the ground. It was easy to miss if you were not looking for it.

> *Then said the LORD unto Moses: 'Behold, I will cause to rain bread from heaven for you; and the people shall go out and gather a day's portion every day, that I may prove them, whether they will walk in My law, or not. (Exodus 16:4)*

הִנְנִי מַמְטִיר לָכֶם לֶחֶם מִן־הַשָּׁמָיִם

hin-NI mam-TIR la-CHEM LE-chem min ha-sha-MA-yim

here, I will rain bread for you from heaven

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Read the verse, then the Hebrew three times. Write on a slip of paper only what you must pay or do today. Nothing for tomorrow. Say: "You rain bread from heaven. I gather today's portion today." At midday, look at the slip and do one thing on it.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

When next month's numbers come into your head this morning, write them on a separate page and close it. They will still be there tomorrow. Today you gather today. Then look up from the page and go out into your day, the way they went out of their tents.

Tonight: *Write in the notebook "a day's portion every day," and under it what today's portion was. Say "bread from heaven" before you sleep.*

DAY 16

Nothing Over, No Lack

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

This is the verse the Mishnah Berurah points to when he explains why we say the passage of the manna. The people went out and gathered. Some gathered more, some less. Then they measured it, and something strange happened. The one who gathered much had nothing extra. The one who gathered little had no lack. Each one had exactly what he needed to eat. No more, and no less.

Think about what that means for the person who works himself sick, and for the person who can't work as much as he used to. The verse does not say effort is useless. They all went out and gathered. It says the measure was set by Hashem, each one according to his eating.

This is the end of comparing. Your neighbor's income, your brother's house, the couple down the street with the new car. In the wilderness, nobody's omer was bigger at the end. Today you stop measuring your portion against anyone else's.

There is one more word to see: "every man for them that are in his tent." Each person gathered for his household. Some had many mouths to feed, some had few. The measure fit the tent. If you are feeding children or grandchildren, or helping a family member who has fallen on hard times, your tent is bigger than it looks on paper. The verse says the gathering is counted by the people in the tent. Hashem sees everyone you carry, not only you.

> *This is the thing which the LORD hath commanded: Gather ye of it every man according to his eating; an omer a head, according to the number of your persons, shall ye take it, every man for them that are in his tent.' And the children of Israel did so, and gathered some more, some less. And when they did mete it with an omer, he that gathered much had nothing over, and he that gathered little had no lack; they gathered every man according to his eating. (Exodus 16:16-18)*

לֹא הֶעְדִּיף הַמַּרְבֶּה וְהַמַּמְעִיט לֹא הֶחְסִיר

lo he'-DIF ha-mar-BEH, ve-ha-mam-IT lo hech-SIR

the one with much had nothing over, the one with little had no lack

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Read the three verses, then the Hebrew three times. Think of one person you compare yourself to about money. Bless them by name. Say: "My measure is from You. I have no lack of what I need." At midday, when you catch yourself comparing, stop and say: "Each according to his eating."

Tonight: *Write in the notebook: "he that gathered little had no lack." Under it, write one way today's portion was enough.*

DAY 17

Leave Nothing Till Morning

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

Moses gave one simple rule: don't keep any of it until morning. And some people did not listen. They hid a little away, just in case. In the morning it had bred worms and rotted.

Why would Hashem make the bread spoil? Because the extra was not really extra bread. It was worry with a crust on it. The people who kept some back were saying, "Maybe He won't come through tomorrow." The bread could not hold that fear. It went bad.

This is not a teaching against saving money. The Torah itself will tell you, in two days, of a day when keeping some over was the commandment. This is a teaching about the fear underneath. What are you holding back, not out of wisdom, but out of fear? A worry you keep checking, a balance you look at ten times a day? Today you let one of those go before the morning.

Notice who got angry. Not Hashem in this verse, but Moses. He was wroth with them, because he had told them plainly, and they did not listen. Sometimes the old fear is so strong that you do the thing you know will spoil, just to feel safe for one night. Today is not about guilt for that. It is about listening one time more than you did yesterday. Leave one thing to Him till morning, and see that the morning still comes with bread.

> *And Moses said unto them: 'Let no man leave of it till the morning.' Notwithstanding they hearkened not unto Moses; but some of them left of it until the morning, and it bred worms, and rotted; and Moses was wroth with them. (Exodus 16:19-20)*

אִישׁ אַל־יוֹתֵר מִמֶּנּוּ עַד־בֹּקֶר

ish al yo-TER mi-ME-nu ad BO-ker

let no one leave any of it until morning

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Read both verses, then the Hebrew three times. Name one fear you keep "in reserve," something you check again and again. Say: "I will not keep this fear till morning. Tomorrow's bread is in Your hand." At midday, when the urge comes to check that thing again, don't. Say the Hebrew line instead.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

Look at your balance once a day, at a set time, and then let it be. Checking it ten times won't add a dollar. It only feeds the worm.

Tonight: *Write in the notebook the fear you released today. Then write: "Let no man leave of it till the morning," and close the book without going back to it.*

DAY 18

The Double Portion

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

Here is the day that answers yesterday. On the sixth day, the people went out and found twice as much. Two omers each. The leaders ran to Moses, confused. And Moses told them: tomorrow is the holy Sabbath. Bake what you want, cook what you want, and keep the rest until morning.

And this time, what was kept did not rot. No worms. The same bread that spoiled when it was kept out of fear stayed fresh when it was kept by His word.

So the lesson of the manna is not "never save." It is "keep what He tells you to keep, the way He tells you." Planning for the Sabbath was obedience, not fear. In your life, this is the difference between a fearful hoard and an ordered plan. One rots. The other rests.

And look at the gift inside the commandment: a day with no gathering at all. Six days you gather. On the seventh you rest, and the bread is already there.

There is a quiet lesson in the leaders too. They saw the double portion and came running, worried that something was wrong. Even good news can frighten a worried heart. Moses calmed them with the word of Hashem: this is what the LORD has spoken. When something unexpected comes into your life, even something good, bring it back to His word before you decide what it means. The double portion was not a mistake. It was a gift with a purpose.

> *And it came to pass that on the sixth day they gathered twice as much bread, two omers for each one; and all the rulers of the congregation came and told Moses. And he said unto them: 'This is that which the LORD hath spoken: To-morrow is a solemn rest, a holy sabbath unto the LORD. Bake that which ye will bake, and seethe that which ye will seethe; and all that remaineth over lay up for you to be kept until the morning.' And they laid it up till the morning, as Moses bade; and it did not rot, neither was there any worm therein. And Moses said: 'Eat that to-day; for to-day is a sabbath unto the LORD; to-day ye shall not find it in the field. Six days ye shall gather it; but on the seventh day is the sabbath, in it there shall be none.' (Exodus 16:22-26)*

שַׁבָּתוֹן שַׁבַּת־קֹדֶשׁ לַיהוָה מָחָר

sha-ba-TON sha-BAT KO-desh la-Adonai ma-CHAR

tomorrow is a solemn rest, a holy Sabbath to the LORD

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Read the verses, then the Hebrew three times. Choose the time this week when you will not look at money at all, the Sabbath or a set rest. Say: "Six days I gather. On the day of rest, Your bread is already in my house." At midday, write one thing you will prepare ahead so the rest day is free.

Tonight: *Write in the notebook: "it did not rot." Under it, write what you will prepare for your day of rest this week.*

DAY 19

Forty Years at His Table

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep · Read the whole passage today (Exodus 16:4-36)

You met this verse in Chapter 1. Forty years. Every morning of forty years, bread was on the ground. Not one morning missed. Through every complaint, every mistake, every hidden portion that rotted, the bread kept coming, until they reached the land.

Now come back to the parable of Rabbi Shimon bar Yochai in the Talmud, tractate Yoma, page 76a. The king gives his son his allowance one day at a time, so the son will come to him every day. The families in the wilderness, with children to feed, could not stop thinking about tomorrow. And so every day they turned their hearts to their Father in heaven.

You are now at Day 19. That means nineteen mornings you have turned to Him about money. Not because you had to, but because you chose to. That is the son coming to the king. Today, take a little longer. Read the whole passage of the manna, Exodus 16:4-36, slowly. It takes about ten minutes. It is the passage the Shulchan Aruch says is good to say every day.

Think of what those forty years held. Children were born who had never eaten anything but manna. Old people grew older on it. The whole people learned to wake up and look at the ground before they looked at anything else. In a small way, that is what your mornings are becoming. You wake, and before the phone, before the bills, you look for His word. That habit, built day by day, is the real inheritance of the wilderness.

> *And the children of Israel did eat the manna forty years, until they came to a land inhabited; they did eat the manna, until they came unto the borders of the land of Canaan. (Exodus 16:35)*

וּבְנֵי יִשְׂרָאֵל אָכְלוּ אֶת־הַמָּן אַרְבָּעִים שָׁנָה

u-ve-NEI yis-ra-EL a-che-LU et ha-MAN ar-ba-IM sha-NAH

the children of Israel ate the manna forty years

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Read the verse, then the Hebrew three times. Read the whole passage, Exodus 16:4-36, slowly, out loud if you can. Say: "Every day You fed them, and every day they turned to You. I turn to You today, my Father." At midday, stop for one minute and simply speak to Hashem as a child to a father, in your own words.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

The king did not send the allowance daily to keep his son poor. He sent it daily to keep his son close. When you feel the daily need, hear it as an invitation.

Tonight: *Write in the notebook one sentence you would say to your Father in heaven about your money, as plainly as a child. Say it out loud before you sleep.*

DAY 20

Not by Bread Only

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

Forty years later, at the edge of the land, Moses looks back at the wilderness and tells the people what the manna was for. It was not only to fill their stomachs. It was so they would know that a person does not live by bread only, but by every word that comes out of the mouth of the LORD.

Notice the hard words first. "He afflicted thee, and suffered thee to hunger." The hunger was real. Moses does not pretend it was not. But the hunger was not the end of the story. It was the classroom where they learned what really keeps a person alive.

You have known hunger of some kind, the empty account, the bare cupboard, the fear at the end of the month. This verse does not shame you for it. It tells you there is a food under the food. Hashem's word has been feeding you every morning of this program. That word is what holds you up while the bread is on its way.

Notice also the line "which thou knewest not, neither did thy fathers know." The manna was something new. Nobody had seen it before. Hashem fed them in a way they could not have planned for. When you pray about money, you may picture only the ways you already know: a raise, a refund, a check from someone. The verse reminds you that His ways of feeding can be ones you never imagined. Keep your prayer open, and keep your eyes open with it.

> *And He afflicted thee, and suffered thee to hunger, and fed thee with manna, which thou knewest not, neither did thy fathers know; that He might make thee know that man doth not live by bread only, but by every thing that proceedeth out of the mouth of the LORD doth man live. (Deuteronomy 8:3)*

כִּי לֹא עַל־הַלֶּחֶם לְבַדּוֹ יִחְיֶה הָאָדָם

ki lo al ha-LE-chem le-va-DO yich-YEH ha-a-DAM

for a person does not live by bread alone

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Read the verse, then the Hebrew three times. Choose one verse from the last twenty days that has fed you. Say it out loud. Say: "I do not live by bread only. I live by every word from Your mouth." At midday, say that one verse again, from memory if you can.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

If you can't remember a verse from memory, that's fine. Keep this book open on the table at midday and read it. The word feeds you either way.

Tonight: *Write in the notebook the verse that fed you today. Under it: "not by bread only." Say it once more as you lie down.*

DAY 21

The Power to Get Wealth

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep · Or read the whole passage today, if you did not on Day 19

The manna ends. The land comes, with fields and houses and work and money earned. And Moses warns the people about a new danger, one that only comes when things go well. You might say in your heart: "My power and the might of my hand got me this wealth."

The cure is one word: remember. Remember that it is He who gives you the power to get wealth. The strength in your hands, the mind that plans, the job, the check, the skill, all of it is a gift, like the manna was. The bread just comes in a different form now.

This is the right way to close a stage about bread from heaven. In the wilderness it was easy to see where the bread came from. It was lying on the ground every morning. In ordinary life it is easy to forget. So from today, every dollar that comes in, you will say where it came from.

> *and thou say in thy heart: 'My power and the might of my hand hath gotten me this wealth.' But thou shalt remember the LORD thy God, for it is He that giveth thee power to get wealth, that He may establish His covenant which He swore unto thy fathers, as it is this day. (Deuteronomy 8:17-18)*

כִּי הוּא הַנֹּתֵן לְךָ כֹּחַ לַעֲשׂוֹת חָיִל

ki HU ha-no-TEN le-CHA KO-ach la-a-SOT CHA-yil

for it is He who gives you power to get wealth

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Read both verses, then the Hebrew three times. Think of the last money that came into your hands: a check, a payment, a gift. Say: "This did not come from my power alone. You gave me the power to get it." At midday, put one coin in the tzedakah box and say: "From You it came."



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

Don't wait for a big sum to practice this. Say it over the small ones. A heart that remembers over a few dollars will remember over many.

Tonight: *Read back the week in your notebook. Write one line: "It is He that giveth thee power to get wealth." Then write the name of one gift of strength or skill He has given you.*

BEFORE THE NEXT STAGE

- [ ] I gathered today's portion and left tomorrow for tomorrow.
- [ ] I stopped comparing my omer with anyone else's.
- [ ] I released one fear I was keeping "till morning."
- [ ] I set a time of rest when I do not look at money.
- [ ] I read the whole passage of the manna, Exodus 16:4-36, at least once.
- [ ] I said "from You it came" over money that came in.
- [ ] My notebook has a line for each day of this stage.

CHAPTER 5

Stage Three: Guard the Gate (Days 22–28)

You have opened your hand, and you have gathered bread one day at a time. Now comes a quieter question. What you have, who keeps it? A house can fill up and still leak through the door.

What this stage is for

For seven days you will learn to guard what Hashem gives you. You will guard it with blessing, with a quiet mouth, with honest work and with a good eye toward others. The tradition does not teach you to guard money with fear. It teaches you to guard it with trust and with silence, the way Joseph's blessing was hidden from the eye.

Keep the same three moments you have kept since the first seven days: morning on waking, one minute at midday, and a few words at night. Keep your Promise Notebook by the bed. On Day 26 you will also fill in your wallet card.

DAY 22

Joseph's Vine

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

Jacob blessed each of his sons before he died. When he came to Joseph, he did not speak of swords or kings. He spoke of a vine. A vine planted by a spring has water under it all year, and its branches climb over the wall.

Think about that picture for your own life. A vine does not chase water. It is planted where the water already is. Its job is to stay rooted, and the fruit comes over the wall by itself. You have spent three weeks putting your roots down by the spring: the open hand of Hashem, the bread that comes each day. Today you ask to be that vine.

The Sages read this verse as a shield. The Talmud, in tractate Berakhot, page 20a, teaches that the evil eye has no power over the children of Joseph, and it learns this from these very words. We will study that teaching slowly in Part Three, "The Shield." For today, it is enough to know that the blessing of Joseph is a blessing that grows and is guarded at the same time.

Read the verse slowly and listen to how it repeats itself: a fruitful vine, a fruitful vine. Jacob says it twice, as if one blessing were not enough for this son. Joseph had been sold, forgotten, thrown in prison, and still he grew. That is the kind of growth you ask for this week: growth that does not depend on how others treat you.

> *Joseph is a fruitful vine, A fruitful vine by a fountain; Its branches run over the wall. (Genesis 49:22)*

בֵּן פֹּרָת יוֹסֵף בֵּן פֹּרָת עֲלֵי־עָיִן

ben po-RAT yo-SEF, ben po-RAT a-LEI A-yin

Joseph is a fruitful vine, a fruitful vine by a fountain.

What does it mean for you to be "by a fountain"? It means you stop looking at the empty places first. Before you look at the account, the bills or the news, you look at the spring. That is why the morning reading comes before the phone. The first thing your eyes touch each day shapes the rest of it.

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Morning, before you look at money or the phone: read Genesis 49:22 slowly, twice. Say the Hebrew line three times, then say: "I am planted by the spring of Hashem. What I have is guarded, and it will grow." Midday: close your eyes for one minute and picture a vine by water, branches over a wall. Night: say the Hebrew line once more before you lie down.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

Don't worry if the Hebrew feels slow in your mouth. Say it the way a child says a new word, one piece at a time. Hashem hears the heart before the accent.

Tonight: *Write in your Promise Notebook one thing you already have that you want guarded, a roof, a check, a child's health. Write it plainly, then close the book.*

DAY 23

The Priestly Blessing

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

Today's text is three short lines. Hashem gave them to Aaron and his sons, and told them to bless the children of Israel with these exact words. They are some of the oldest words of blessing in the whole Torah, and they are still said today.

Look at the order. First, "bless thee." Then, right away, "keep thee." The Torah does not stop at giving. It asks for guarding. A blessing that comes and then slips away is only half a blessing. The priests asked for both in one breath.

Then the lines grow. The second asks that His face shine on you and that He be gracious. The third asks that He lift up His face toward you and give you peace. Peace is the last word. It is the seal on everything that came before. What good is money in a house with no peace? What good is a full table if you can't sleep at night?

Notice also that each line begins with the Name. The blessing does not come from the priest. He only speaks it. The one who blesses is Hashem. So when you say these lines over yourself or over another person, you are not making the blessing. You are asking the One who gives it. That keeps the heart humble and the words honest.

Say them slowly. There is no hurry in a blessing.

> *The LORD bless thee, and keep thee;*
> *The LORD make His face to shine upon thee, and be gracious unto thee;*
> *The LORD lift up His countenance upon thee, and give thee peace. (Numbers 6:24-26)*

יְבָרֶכְךָ יְהוָה וְיִשְׁמְרֶךָ

ye-va-re-che-CHA Adonai ve-yish-me-RE-cha

The LORD bless you and keep you.

This week is about guarding, and this is the guard's prayer. You are not asking for one more thing. You are asking that what is already coming to you will stay, and that it will come with a shining face and with peace.

You can say these words over yourself. You can also say them over someone you love: a son who is struggling, a grandchild, a friend whose rent is late. A blessing given to another is never lost to you.

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Morning: read Numbers 6:24-26 aloud, slowly, all three lines. Say the first Hebrew line three times. Then say: "Hashem blesses what I have, and Hashem keeps it. He gives my house peace." Midday: say the three lines in English over one person you love, by name, in your heart. Night: say the first line again as you put out the light.

Tonight: *Write in your Promise Notebook the name of the person you blessed at midday. Under it, write one word: peace.*

DAY 24

Your Going Out and Your Coming In

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · On leaving the house · Night, before sleep

Psalm 121 is a short song of ascents. It begins with a person lifting his eyes to the mountains and asking where his help will come from. The answer comes in the second line: from the LORD, who made heaven and earth. By the end, the psalm makes two promises that close the whole song.

The first is that Hashem will keep you from all evil and keep your soul. The second is about your feet. He will guard your going out and your coming in. Think of every door you go through in a day. The door to the bank. The door to the doctor. The door to the store where the prices keep climbing. The door back into your own home at night, tired.

The psalm says each of those is guarded. Not once, but "from this time forth and for ever." You are not asked to be your own guard every hour. Earlier in the same psalm it says the One who keeps you does not slumber. You may sleep. He does not.

The psalm uses one word again and again: keep, keeper, keepeth. In Hebrew it is the root *shamar*, to guard or watch over. It is the same word you said yesterday in the Priestly Blessing, "and keep thee." A guard stands at a gate. This week, Hashem stands at yours.

> *The LORD shall keep thee from all evil; He shall keep thy soul.*
> *The LORD shall guard thy going out and thy coming in, From this time forth and for ever. (Psalm 121:7-8)*

יְהוָה יִשְׁמָר־צֵאתְךָ וּבוֹאֶךָ

Adonai yish-mor tzet-CHA u-vo-E-cha

The LORD will guard your going out and your coming in.

Many people carry a fear when they leave the house about money. Will the card go through? Will the bill be higher this month? Today you take one small step against that fear. Before you go out, you stop at the door and say the verse. When you come back in, you say it again. The door becomes a reminder, not a worry.

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Morning: read Psalm 121:7-8 twice, then say the Hebrew line three times. Each time you leave the house today, pause at the door and say: "Hashem guards my going out." Each time you come back in, say: "Hashem guards my coming in." Night: read verse 8 once more, then say: "He that keepeth me does not slumber. I may sleep."



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

If you don't go out today, say it at the door of your bedroom. The doorway is not the point. Your heart passing through it is.

Tonight: *Write in your Promise Notebook every door you passed through today where you felt worry. Next to each one, write "guarded."*

DAY 25

Except the LORD Build the House

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

Psalm 127 is short and blunt. Unless the LORD builds the house, the builders labor in vain. Unless the LORD keeps the city, the watchman stays awake for nothing. Then the second verse turns to you, the one who gets up early and stays up late, worried, eating "the bread of toil."

That last phrase is worth a slow look. The bread of toil is bread eaten with a knot in the stomach. It is supper eaten while you do the math on the back of an envelope. The psalm does not say work is bad. It says that the worry on top of the work adds nothing. "So He giveth unto His beloved in sleep."

That is a hard sentence for anyone who lies awake at three in the morning. Yet it is in the Bible, and it says plainly that Hashem gives to the one He loves even while that one is asleep. Your rest is not laziness. It is trust.

> *Except the LORD build the house, They labour in vain that build it; Except the LORD keep the city, The watchman waketh but in vain.*
> *It is vain for you that ye rise early, and sit up late, Ye that eat the bread of toil; So He giveth unto His beloved in sleep. (Psalm 127:1-2)*

אִם־יְהוָה לֹא־יִבְנֶה בַּיִת

im Adonai lo yiv-NEH VA-yit

Unless the LORD builds the house.

Your house is more than walls. It is the people in it, the meals, the quiet. The Talmud, in tractate Bava Metzia, page 59a, teaches that a man should honor his wife, because the blessing rests in a home on her account. Whoever you share your home with,

today is a day to honor them. A house where people are honored is a house Hashem is building.

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Morning: read Psalm 127:1-2 slowly, then say the Hebrew line three times. Say: "Hashem builds my house. Hashem keeps my door. I do my part and I rest." Midday: do one kind thing for someone in your home, or call someone who is family to you. Night: before sleep, read verse 2 and say: "He gives to His beloved in sleep."



Put the bills down. Except the LORD build the house, the builders labor in vain.

Tonight: *Do not do any money math after supper. Write one line in your Promise Notebook: "Tonight I rest. Hashem keeps the city."*

DAY 26

Little by Little (The Wallet Card)

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Each time you open your wallet · Night, before sleep

Today is the day of the wallet card. At the back of this book you'll find it. Cut it out, fill it in with your name and today's date, and keep it in your wallet where your money sits. From today on, every time you open your wallet, you'll see this verse.

The verse is from Proverbs. It sets two kinds of wealth side by side. The first is "wealth gotten by vanity." The Hebrew word is *hevel*, the same word for breath or vapor. It means money that comes fast, without substance: the scheme, the gamble, the promise that sounds too good. That money, the verse says, shrinks.

The second kind is wealth gathered "little by little." The Hebrew says, literally, gathered "by hand." One coin, then another. One bill paid, then the next. This is the wealth that grows. It is not exciting. It is steady. And Proverbs says it is the one that will increase.

You may wonder whether such a small habit can matter. Think of what you learned with the manna. It came each day, and each day was enough. Wealth gathered by hand works the same way. It is not one big moment. It is many small, honest ones.

> *Wealth gotten by vanity shall be diminished; But he that gathereth little by little shall increase. (Proverbs 13:11)*

הוֹן מֵהֶבֶל יִמְעָט וְקֹבֵץ עַל־יָד יַרְבֶּה

hon me-HE-vel yim-AT, ve-ko-VETZ al yad yar-BEH

Wealth from vapor shrinks; one who gathers by hand will increase.

Why in the wallet? Because the wallet is where the small choices are made. The impulse buy. The "just this once." The phone call from a stranger promising a quick return. When you open the wallet and see the card, you stop for one breath and ask: is this vapor, or is this little by little?

Remember what you learned in the first seven days about the hidden blessing. The card is for your eyes. You don't show it off, and you don't count your money in front of it. You just let it remind you.

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Morning: read Proverbs 13:11 twice, then say the Hebrew line three times. Cut out the wallet card from the back of the book. Write your name and today's date. Put it in your wallet. Say: "I gather little by little, and what I gather by hand will increase." Every time you open your wallet today, read the card once, silently.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

Little by little means little. Put one coin a day in your tzedakah box, pay one small bill early, skip one thing you don't need. Small and steady is the whole teaching.

Tonight: *Write in your Promise Notebook one small, steady step you took today with money. Then write the verse once, by hand.*

DAY 27

The Blessing That Makes Rich

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

Proverbs 10:22 is short enough to learn by heart. The blessing of the LORD makes rich, and toil adds nothing to it. Read it twice. The first half tells you where wealth comes from. The second half tells you what doesn't add to it.

The Hebrew word for "toil" here, *etzev*, also carries the sense of pain or sorrow. It is the same family of words as "the bread of toil" you read two days ago in Psalm 127. So the verse can be heard this way: the blessing of Hashem makes rich, and the sorrow you add on top does not add a thing.

That is a freeing sentence for a worried person. You do your work. You pay what you can. You are careful. But the worry, the hours of turning it over in your head, that part adds nothing. You can set it down. In the second stage you read that with the manna, he that gathered much had nothing over, and he that gathered little had no lack. This verse says the same thing in one line.

Try a small test today. Each time a worry about money rises, notice what it is offering you. Does it pay the bill? Does it bring a dollar closer? Usually it offers only a tight chest and a sleepless night. The verse is honest about that: it adds nothing. Hashem's blessing is what adds.

> *The blessing of the LORD, it maketh rich, And toil addeth nothing thereto. (Proverbs 10:22)*

בִּרְכַּת יְהוָה הִיא תַעֲשִׁיר

bir-KAT Adonai hi ta-a-SHIR

The blessing of the LORD, it makes rich.

Notice that the verse does not say "your effort makes rich." Nor does it say "your luck makes rich." It says the blessing. And a blessing is something you receive, something you ask for, something you guard. That is what this whole stage has been about.

So today, when the worry comes, and it will, you answer it with this line. You don't argue with the worry. You just say the verse and go back to what you were doing.

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Morning: read Proverbs 10:22 three times, slowly, then say the Hebrew line three times. Say: "The blessing of Hashem makes me rich. My worry adds nothing. I set it down." Midday: when a money worry comes, say the Hebrew line once and return to your work. Night: read the verse once more before sleep.

Tonight: *Write in your Promise Notebook one worry you carried today. Draw a line through it, and under it write: "Toil adds nothing. The blessing makes rich."*

DAY 28

The Good Eye

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

The last day of this stage turns the guarding outward. You have been asking Hashem to guard what is yours. Today you learn the other half: how you look at what belongs to others.

The verse says, "He that hath a bountiful eye shall be blessed." In Hebrew the words are *tov ayin*, a good eye. A good eye is a generous eye. It looks at a neighbor's new car and is glad for him. It sees someone in need and gives from its own bread. The verse gives the reason in the same breath: he is blessed "for he giveth of his bread to the poor."

The Mishnah, in Pirkei Avot, chapter 5, teaching 19, says that a good eye, a humble spirit and a modest appetite mark the students of Abraham. It teaches that they enjoy this world and inherit the World to Come. The opposite, a bad eye, it links with Bilaam, the prophet who came to curse. So the good eye is not only a feeling. It is a mark of whose student you are.

> *He that hath a bountiful eye shall be blessed; For he giveth of his bread to the poor. (Proverbs 22:9)*

טוֹב־עַיִן הוּא יְבֹרָךְ

tov A-yin hu ye-vo-RACH

One with a good eye will be blessed.

Here is the connection to this whole week. The person who looks at others with a good eye is not afraid of their eye either. A generous heart has nothing to guard against. In Part Three you will study the shield in full. For now, practice the good eye.

You don't need much to give. A slice of your bread is still bread. A coin in the tzedakah box, as you have done since the first seven days, still counts.

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Morning: read Proverbs 22:9 twice, then say the Hebrew line three times. Say: "I look at others with a good eye. I give of my bread, and I am blessed."
Midday: give something today, a coin, a meal, an hour, a kind word to someone who needs it. Once today, when you see someone else's good fortune, say quietly: "May it grow for him."



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

If envy comes, don't be ashamed of it. Just turn it into a blessing out loud. Envy can't survive a blessing said for the very person you envy.

Tonight: *Write in your Promise Notebook what you gave today and to whom, if you know. Then write the name of one person whose good fortune you blessed.*

BEFORE THE NEXT STAGE

- [ ] I read the morning text before looking at money or the phone on most days this week.
- [ ] I can say "ben po-RAT yo-SEF" from memory.
- [ ] I blessed one person I love with the Priestly Blessing.
- [ ] I said Psalm 121:8 at my door, going out and coming in.
- [ ] My wallet card is filled in and in my wallet.
- [ ] I gave something this week with a good eye.
- [ ] My Promise Notebook has an entry for each of the seven nights.

CHAPTER 6

Stage Four: The Work of Your Hands (Days 29–35)

Some readers stopped working years ago. Some work more hours than ever just to keep up. Either way, your hands still do something every day, and the Torah says the blessing is sent into what your hands touch.

What this stage is for

This week you ask Hashem to bless the work of your hands, whatever that work is. It may be a job or a small business. It may be cooking, caring for a grandchild, mending, managing a retirement check with great care. In the eyes of the Torah, all of it is the work of your hands.

You will also learn the tradition's teaching on the tithe this week, with its limits. The Sages taught people to give, and they also taught people not to give themselves into need. Keep the same three moments each day, and keep writing at night.

DAY 29

The Blessing Commanded

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Before you start your first task · Night, before sleep

Deuteronomy 28 is a long list of blessings. One verse stands out for this week. It says the LORD will *command* the blessing to be with you, in your barns and in all that you put your hand to. The blessing is not left to chance. It is commanded, the way a king commands a servant.

Look at where the blessing goes. First, "in thy barns," the place where what you already have is stored. Then, "in all that thou puttest thy hand unto." The blessing goes to two places: what you keep and what you do. This stage is about the second place. Last week you guarded the barn. This week you bring your hands.

Notice, too, that the verse needs you to put your hand to something. The blessing is sent into the work. It does not ask you to wear yourself out, as you learned in Psalm 127. It asks you to begin.

The word "command" also tells you something about Hashem's care. A command is not a maybe. When the King commands, the servant goes. When the Torah says the blessing is commanded into the work of your hands, it is telling you that your small tasks are not beneath His notice.

> *The LORD will command the blessing with thee in thy barns, and in all that thou puttest thy hand unto; and He will bless thee in the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee. (Deuteronomy 28:8)*

יְצַו יְהוָה אִתְּךָ אֶת־הַבְּרָכָה

ye-TZAV Adonai it-CHA et ha-be-ra-CHAH

The LORD will command the blessing with you.

The Talmud, in tractate Taanit, page 8b, teaches that someone who goes to measure his grain should first pray that Hashem send blessing into the work of his hands. If he measures first and prays afterward, the prayer is in vain, because blessing is found only in what is hidden from the eye. So the prayer comes before the work, not after the counting.

That is the order you will keep all week. Pray first. Then begin.

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Morning: read Deuteronomy 28:8 twice, then say the Hebrew line three times. Before your first task of the day, put both hands on the table and say: "Hashem commands the blessing into what my hands do today." Then begin the task, and don't count or check the result right away. Night: read the verse once more.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

Your first task can be small. Washing the dishes is the work of your hands. So is writing a letter or balancing the checkbook. Bless it first, then do it.

Tonight: *Write in your Promise Notebook the first task you blessed today. Write how it felt to begin with a blessing instead of a worry.*

DAY 30

His Good Treasure

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

Today's verse opens a door upward. The LORD will open His good treasure, the heavens, to give rain to your land in its season. For a farmer in the land of Israel, rain was everything. No rain, no crop. No crop, no bread. So the verse is speaking about the very source of a year's living.

Then it brings it back to your hands: "and to bless all the work of thy hand." The rain and the work go together. Hashem sends the rain. You plow and plant. The verse ends with a line many readers carry close: "thou shalt lend unto many nations, but thou shalt not borrow."

If you carry debt, that line can sting. Don't let it. It is a blessing, not a judgment. It shows you the direction the blessing moves: from owing toward lending, from borrowing toward giving. You took your first step on that road in the first seven days, when you set your debts in order before Hashem. This verse shows you where the road goes.

Think of the farmer who plowed in the autumn and waited. He couldn't make it rain. He could only prepare the ground and trust. Your work is the same. You prepare the ground: you pay what you can, you keep your accounts in order, you show up. The treasure of heaven is opened by Hashem, in its season.

> *The LORD will open unto thee His good treasure the heaven to give the rain of thy land in its season, and to bless all the work of thy hand; and thou shalt lend unto many nations, but thou shalt not borrow. (Deuteronomy 28:12)*

יִפְתַּח יְהוָה לְךָ אֶת־אוֹצָרוֹ הַטּוֹב

yif-TACH Adonai le-CHA et o-tza-RO ha-TOV

The LORD will open for you His good treasure.

Look at the words "in its season." Rain that comes at the wrong time does harm. Rain in its season brings the crop. You are not asking for everything at once. You are asking that what you need come when you need it. That is a prayer you can pray with a calm heart.

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Morning: read Deuteronomy 28:12 slowly, then say the Hebrew line three times. Say: "Hashem opens His good treasure for me, in its season. He blesses the work of my hands. I am moving from borrowing to giving." Midday: look at one debt or bill and say the Hebrew line once over it, without doing any math. Night: read the last line of the verse once more before sleep.

Tonight: *Write in your Promise Notebook one thing you need, and next to it write "in its season." Then let it rest until morning.*

DAY 31

Establish the Work of Our Hands

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

Psalm 90 is a psalm about time: how short a life is, how quickly the years go. It speaks honestly about our days passing like a sigh. Then, at the very end, it turns to a prayer.

"Establish Thou also upon us the work of our hands." Then it says it again: "Yea, the work of our hands establish Thou it." Why twice? Because the one praying is worried that his work won't last. He has watched the years pass. He has seen what people build fall apart. So he asks twice that Hashem make it firm.

Many readers of this book have that same worry. Will what I built hold? The house, the savings, the family? This prayer is for you. It does not pretend that time stands still. It asks that what you have done with your hands be made to stand.

Notice, too, that the prayer says "our hands," not "my hands." Moses prays for the whole people. Your work is tied up with the work of others: the family you raised, the neighbors you helped, the people who will come after you. When you ask Hashem to establish your work, you are asking for all of them.

> *And let the graciousness of the Lord our God be upon us; Establish Thou also upon us the work of our hands; Yea, the work of our hands establish Thou it. (Psalm 90:17)*

וּמַעֲשֵׂה יָדֵינוּ כּוֹנְנֵהוּ

u-ma-a-SEH ya-DEI-nu ko-ne-NE-hu

And the work of our hands, establish it.

The prayer begins with "the graciousness of the Lord." The Hebrew word, *no'am*, means pleasantness or sweetness. Before Moses asks for anything to last, he asks for the sweetness of Hashem to rest on us. A work done in sweetness lasts longer than a work done in fear.



Establish Thou also upon us the work of our hands.

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Morning: read Psalm 90:17 twice, then say the Hebrew line three times. Say: "Hashem, let Your sweetness rest on me. Make firm the work of my hands." Midday: touch something you have made or kept with care for years, and say the Hebrew line once. Night: read the verse once more.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

Work you did forty years ago still counts. The children you raised, the house you kept, the people you helped. Ask Hashem to make all of it firm, not just today's work.

Tonight: *Write in your Promise Notebook one work of your hands from your past that you are thankful for, and one work of today.*

DAY 32

You Shall Eat the Labor of Your Hands

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · At a meal · Night, before sleep

Psalm 128 is another song of ascents. It begins with happiness: happy is everyone who fears the LORD and walks in His ways. The second verse brings that happiness down to the table. When you eat the labor of your hands, you will be happy, and it will be well with you.

That is a simple picture. Not a palace, not a vault. A table, and food on it that came from honest work. The Mishnah, in Pirkei Avot, chapter 4, teaching 1, quotes this very verse. Ben Zoma asks who is rich, and answers: the one who is glad with his portion.

You met Ben Zoma's teaching in the first stage. Today you go to the verse behind it. Being glad with your portion does not mean you stop asking. It means you eat today's bread with joy, while you trust Hashem for tomorrow's.

There is something else in this verse. It does not say "when you eat the labor of someone else's hands." It is your own labor. The food on your table, however plain, is honest food. There is a dignity in that which no one can take from you, and the psalm calls it happiness.

So today, eat slowly. Taste it. Give thanks. If you share the meal with someone, let them hear you say the words. A grateful table teaches more than a lecture.

> *A Song of Ascents. Happy is every one that feareth the LORD, That walketh in His ways.*
> *When thou eatest the labour of thy hands, Happy shalt thou be, and it shall be well with thee. (Psalm 128:1-2)*

יְגִיעַ כַּפֶּיךָ כִּי תֹאכֵל אַשְׁרֶיךָ וְטוֹב לָךְ׃

ye-GI-a ka-PE-cha ki to-CHEL, ash-RE-cha ve-TOV lach

When you eat the labor of your hands, you are happy, and it is well with you.

What is the labor of your hands, if you no longer have a job? Your retirement check was earned by years of work. Your Social Security, your pension, your savings: each is the fruit of labor you already did. When you eat from it, you are eating the labor of your hands. You are allowed to be glad.

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Morning: read Psalm 128:1-2 slowly, then say the Hebrew line three times. At one meal today, before you eat, look at the food and say: "This is the labor of my hands. I am glad, and it is well with me." Eat that meal slowly, without the news or the phone. Night: read verse 2 once more.

Tonight: *Write in your Promise Notebook what you ate at that meal and one thing about it you were glad for.*

DAY 33

Joseph in His Master's House

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

You began last week with Joseph's blessing. Today you meet Joseph at his lowest. His brothers had sold him. He was a slave in Egypt, in the house of a stranger. No money, no family, no rights.

Yet the verse says, "the LORD was with Joseph, and he was a prosperous man." Prosperous, while still a slave? Yes. The Torah measures success by something deeper than position. Joseph did his work faithfully, and Hashem made it prosper. His master saw it. The next verse says the master saw that the LORD was with him and made all that he did prosper in his hand.

This is a word for anyone who feels stuck: in a hard job, in a small check, in a place they didn't choose. The blessing is not waiting until you get out. It can rest on the work you do right where you are. Joseph didn't wait for better days to do good work. The good work came first.

Think about what Joseph's master saw. He didn't see a vision. He saw a man whose work kept going well. Day after day, what Joseph touched prospered, and the master noticed. The blessing on Joseph was visible in ordinary tasks done faithfully. Yours can be too.

> *And the LORD was with Joseph, and he was a prosperous man; and he was in the house of his master the Egyptian.*
> *And his master saw that the LORD was with him, and that the LORD made all that he did to prosper in his hand. (Genesis 39:2-3)*

וְכֹל אֲשֶׁר־הוּא עֹשֶׂה יְהוָה מַצְלִיחַ בְּיָדוֹ

ve-CHOL a-SHER hu o-SEH Adonai matz-LI-ach be-ya-DO

All that he did, the LORD made prosper in his hand.

Notice that the success was "in his hand." Not in his luck, not in his master's mood. In his hand. That is why this stage is called the work of your hands. Whatever your hand is doing today, it can be the place where Hashem's success shows up.

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Morning: read Genesis 39:2-3 twice, then say the Hebrew line three times. Say: "Hashem is with me where I am. He makes what I do prosper in my hand." Midday: do one task today with extra care, as Joseph did, whether or not anyone sees it. Night: read verse 3 once more.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

You don't need a new place to start being blessed. Start in the place you have. That is what Joseph did.

Tonight: *Write in your Promise Notebook the task you did with extra care today, and where you were when you did it.*

DAY 34

Bring the Tithe

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

Today's verse from Malachi is the only place in the Bible where Hashem says, in effect, "test Me." Bring the whole tithe into the storehouse, He says, and try Me now with this. See if I will not open the windows of heaven and pour out a blessing until there is more than enough.

The Talmud, in tractate Taanit, page 9a, plays on the Hebrew words of Deuteronomy 14:22, *asser te'asser*, "you shall surely tithe." It reads them as "tithe so that you will become rich." It tells that Rabbi Yochanan said to the young son of Resh Lakish, in effect, go and test it. The Sages explain that in every other matter it is forbidden to test Hashem, but here it is allowed, because of this very verse in Malachi.

So the tithe is a door the tradition left open. But read the rest of the tradition too, because it holds you safe.

> *Bring ye the whole tithe into the store-house, that there may be food in My house, and try Me now herewith, Saith the LORD of hosts, if I will not open you the windows of heaven, and pour you out a blessing, that there shall be more than sufficiency. (Malachi 3:10)*

וַהֲרִיקֹתִי לָכֶם בְּרָכָה עַד־בְּלִי־דָי

va-ha-ri-ko-TI la-CHEM be-ra-CHAH ad be-li-DAI

I will pour out for you a blessing beyond what is enough.

THE LIMIT THE SAGES SET

The Talmud, in tractate Ketubot, page 50a, records that the Sages gathered at Usha ruled that a person should not give away more than a fifth, so that he does not fall into need himself. The Shulchan Aruch, in Yoreh De'ah 249:1, teaches that a fifth is the finest way to give, a tenth is the middle way, and less than that shows a stingy eye. It also says not to give away more than a fifth during one's lifetime.

Read that again if your money is tight. The Sages themselves put a ceiling on giving. They did not want anyone to give the rent away. If a tenth is more than you can manage right now, give what you can, steadily, little by little. The tithe is a practice of trust, not a trap.

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Morning: read Malachi 3:10 twice, then say the Hebrew line three times. Look honestly at what comes in this month. Decide on a portion to set apart for giving, a tenth if you can, less if you must, never more than a fifth. Put the first coins of it in your tzedakah box today. Say: "I bring my portion with a good eye. Hashem opens the windows of heaven."



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

Don't give money you need for food, medicine or rent. Give from what is truly yours to give. The Sages capped it at a fifth, and I'm not going to ask you for more than they did.

Tonight: *Write in your Promise Notebook the portion you chose for this month. Don't write the amount. Write only the word you chose: "a tenth," "a fifth," or "what I can."*

DAY 35

The One Who Teaches You to Profit

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Before any money decision · Night, before sleep

The last day of this stage brings a verse from Isaiah. Hashem speaks to Israel as their Redeemer and says: I am the LORD your God, who teaches you for your profit, who leads you on the way you should go.

That is a remarkable word. Hashem doesn't only give. He teaches. And He teaches *for your profit*. The Hebrew word, *leho'il*, means to benefit, to do good to, to be of use. Hashem is not hiding the way from you. He is willing to show it, step by step, the way a teacher shows a student.

Think of the money decisions in front of you. Which bill to pay first. Whether to take that offer. Whether to help that relative. Today's verse says you don't have to decide alone. You can ask the Teacher before you decide.

> *Thus saith the LORD, thy Redeemer, The Holy One of Israel: I am the LORD thy God, Who teacheth thee for thy profit, Who leadeth thee by the way that thou shouldest go. (Isaiah 48:17)*

אֲנִי יְהוָה אֱלֹהֶיךָ מְלַמֶּדְךָ לְהוֹעִיל

a-NI Adonai e-lo-HE-cha me-la-med-CHA le-ho-IL

I am the LORD your God, who teaches you to profit.

How does Hashem teach? The tradition points to His word, which you have been reading every morning for five weeks. It points to quiet, to taking time before you decide. It points to honest counsel. Rarely is the answer a voice from the sky. More often it is a calm thought after a prayer, or a door that closes on its own.

So today, before any decision about money, stop and say this verse. Then wait one minute before you act. That minute is where the teaching happens.

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Morning: read Isaiah 48:17 twice, then say the Hebrew line three times. Say: "Hashem teaches me for my good and leads me on my way." Before any money decision today, large or small, say the Hebrew line once and wait one full minute. Night: read the verse once more.

Tonight: *Write in your Promise Notebook any decision you paused over today, and what you chose after the minute of waiting.*

BEFORE THE NEXT STAGE

- [ ] I said a blessing before beginning my work, before counting the result.
- [ ] I said Deuteronomy 28:12 over a debt or bill without doing math.
- [ ] I ate one meal slowly and called it the labor of my hands.
- [ ] I chose a giving portion for this month, no more than a fifth.
- [ ] The first coins of that portion are in my tzedakah box.
- [ ] I paused one minute before a money decision.
- [ ] My Promise Notebook has an entry for each of the seven nights.

CHAPTER 7

Stage Five: The Mountain (Days 36–40)

Moses went up the mountain and stayed forty days. You have climbed for thirty-five. These last five days are the top of the climb, where you see how far you've come.

What this stage is for

In this final stage you read about the forty days of Moses, and about two widows whose jars would not run dry. You end with a psalm of blessing and a psalm of thanks. On Day 40 you read your whole Promise Notebook from the first page.

These days are not harder than the others. They are quieter. Keep your three moments, and give the morning reading a few extra minutes if you can.

DAY 36

Forty Days on the Mountain

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

The number forty runs all through the Torah. The rain of the flood fell forty days and forty nights. The people ate the manna for forty years. The spies came back after forty days. And today's verse: Moses went into the midst of the cloud, went up the mountain, and was there forty days and forty nights.

Why does the Torah use forty so often? It is the length of a real change. Not a quick one. Forty days is long enough to break an old habit and build a new one. When Moses came down, he did not come down the same man. He came down carrying the words of the covenant.

You are coming to the end of your own forty days. Day 1 was not Day 36. The person who began this program was worried in a different way than you are now. You may still have bills. You may still have debts. But something in the way you begin your morning has changed.

Remember Elijah, too. The book of Kings says he walked forty days and forty nights in the strength of that meal until he came to Horeb, the mount of God. What Hashem gave him was enough for the whole road. Your forty days have been fed the same way, one morning reading at a time.

> *And Moses entered into the midst of the cloud, and went up into the mount; and Moses was in the mount forty days and forty nights. (Exodus 24:18)*

וַיְהִי מֹשֶׁה בָּהָר אַרְבָּעִים יוֹם וְאַרְבָּעִים לָיְלָה

vai-HI mo-SHEH ba-HAR ar-ba-IM yom ve-ar-ba-IM LAI-lah

And Moses was on the mountain forty days and forty nights.

Look at the first words: Moses "entered into the midst of the cloud." He couldn't see far. The cloud was thick. He went in anyway. Some of your forty days may have felt like that, walking in a cloud, not seeing results. That is how the mountain is climbed.

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Morning: read Exodus 24:18 twice, then say the Hebrew line three times. Say: "I have walked into the cloud and kept climbing. Hashem has been with me on the mountain." Midday: open your Promise Notebook to the first page and read one entry from the first week. Night: read the verse once more.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

If you missed some days along the way, you're still on the mountain. Moses didn't count your missed days, and neither do I. Finish the five.

Tonight: *Write in your Promise Notebook one way your mornings are different now than they were on Day 1.*

DAY 37

The Jar of Meal

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · In the kitchen · Night, before sleep

During a long drought, Hashem sent Elijah to a widow in Zarephath. She had almost nothing: a handful of meal in a jar, a little oil in a cruse. She was gathering sticks to bake one last cake for herself and her son. Elijah told her not to fear. First make me a little cake, he said, then make for yourself and your son.

That must have been a hard thing to hear. Give first, from almost nothing? Then he gave her the word of the LORD: the jar of meal will not be spent, and the cruse of oil will not fail, until the day the LORD sends rain. She did as he said. And the verses tell us what happened next.

The jar did not overflow. It did not turn into a granary. It simply did not run out. Each day there was enough for that day. You read about this in the second stage, in the manna. It is the same lesson in a widow's kitchen.

> *For thus saith the LORD, the God of Israel: The jar of meal shall not be spent, neither shall the cruse of oil fail, until the day that the LORD sendeth rain upon the land.'*
> *And she went and did according to the saying of Elijah; and she, and he, and her house, did eat many days.*
> *The jar of meal was not spent, neither did the cruse of oil fail, according to the word of the LORD, which He spoke by Elijah. (1 Kings 17:14-16)*

כַּד הַקֶּמַח לֹא כָלָתָה וְצַפַּחַת הַשֶּׁמֶן לֹא חָסֵר

kad ha-KE-mach lo cha-LA-tah, ve-tza-PA-chat ha-SHE-men lo cha-SER

The jar of meal was not spent, and the cruse of oil did not fail.

Notice the words "many days." Not one day, and not forever with nothing to do. Many days, one at a time, until the rain came. That is the shape of provision in the Tanakh. Enough, then enough again.

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Morning: read 1 Kings 17:14-16 slowly, then say the Hebrew line three times. In your kitchen today, put your hand on a jar or a container of flour, rice or oil, and say the Hebrew line once. Say: "My jar will not be spent. My oil will not fail. There is enough for today." Night: read verse 16 once more.



The jar of meal was not spent, neither did the cruse of oil fail.

Tonight: *Write in your Promise Notebook one thing in your house that has not run out, even when you feared it would.*

DAY 38

What Do You Have in the House?

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

The second widow came to the prophet Elisha in tears. Her husband was dead. A creditor was coming to take her two sons as bondmen to pay the debt. If you have ever dreaded a knock at the door, you know her fear.

Elisha asked her two questions. "What shall I do for thee?" and "What hast thou in the house?" She said she had nothing, except a pot of oil. He told her to borrow empty vessels from all her neighbors, and not a few. Then she was to go in, shut the door behind her and her sons, and pour.

She poured, and the oil kept coming as long as there were vessels. When her son said there was not one more vessel, the oil stopped. Then Elisha told her to sell the oil, pay her debt, and live with her sons on the rest.

> *And Elisha said unto her: 'What shall I do for thee? tell me; what hast thou in the house?' And she said: 'Thy handmaid hath not any thing in the house, save a pot of oil.'*
> *Then he said: 'Go, borrow thee vessels abroad of all thy neighbours, even empty vessels; borrow not a few.*
> *And thou shalt go in, and shut the door upon thee and upon thy sons, and pour out into all those vessels; and thou shalt set aside that which is full.'*
> *So she went from him, and shut the door upon her and upon her sons; they brought the vessels to her, and she poured out.*
> *And it came to pass, when the vessels were full, that she said unto her son: 'Bring me yet a vessel.' And he said unto her: 'There is not a vessel more.' And the oil stayed. (2 Kings 4:2-6)*

מַה־יֶּשׁ־לָךְ בַּבָּיִת

mah yesh-LACH ba-BA-yit

What do you have in the house?

Three things stand out. The prophet started with what she already had, not with what she lacked. The oil flowed behind a shut door, hidden from the eye, as you learned in the first seven days. And the oil stopped only when the vessels ran out. The limit was not the oil. It was how many vessels she brought.

So today, ask yourself Elisha's question. What do you have in the house? A skill, a room, a friendship, a little oil? And how many vessels are you willing to bring?

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Morning: read 2 Kings 4:2-6, then say the Hebrew line three times. Write a list of what you have in the house: things, skills, people, time. Keep it private. Say: "I start with what I have. Hashem fills the vessels I bring." Night: read verse 6 once more.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

Don't say "I have nothing." She said that too, and then she remembered the oil. Look again.

Tonight: *Write in your Promise Notebook one "empty vessel" you will bring this week: an effort, a call, a small step you've been putting off.*

DAY 39

The Earth Has Yielded Her Increase

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · Midday, one minute · Night, before sleep

Psalm 67 is a short psalm of blessing. Its opening echoes the Priestly Blessing you said on Day 23: God be gracious to us and bless us, and make His face shine toward us. Then it turns outward. It asks that all the peoples of the earth give thanks.

Near the end comes the line for today: "The earth hath yielded her increase." The harvest is in. And right after it, the psalmist asks again: may God, our own God, bless us. He doesn't stop asking because the harvest has come. He asks for blessing on top of the harvest.

There is a lesson here for the end of your forty days. When things go well, keep praying. When the harvest comes in, give thanks and ask again. The person who prays only in trouble has half a prayer life. Psalm 67 teaches the other half.

The psalm also says "our own God." Not a distant God, not a stranger. Ours. After forty days of turning to Him each morning, you can say those words with more weight than you could on the first day. He is your God, and He has been with you each step.

That is worth a thank-you today. Say it out loud, even if you are alone in the room. Thanks spoken aloud is heard by Hashem, and it is heard by you too.

> *The earth hath yielded her increase; May God, our own God, bless us.*
> *May God bless us; And let all the ends of the earth fear Him. (Psalm 67:7-8)*

אֶ֭רֶץ נָתְנָ֣ה יְבוּלָ֑הּ יְבָרְכֵ֥נוּ אֱ֝לֹהִ֗ים אֱלֹהֵ֥ינוּ

E-retz na-te-NAH ye-vu-LAH, ye-va-re-CHE-nu e-lo-HIM e-lo-HEI-nu

The earth has given her increase; may God, our God, bless us.

Look back over these weeks. What has come in? Maybe not a sum of money. Maybe a calmer night. A bill paid on time. A grandchild's call. A morning that began with Hashem instead of with fear. That is increase too. Today you name it and give thanks for it.

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Morning: read Psalm 67:7-8 twice, then say the Hebrew line three times. Say: "The earth has given her increase to me. Bless me again, Hashem, and let me give thanks." Midday: name aloud one good thing that has come to you in these forty days, and say "thank You." Night: read the whole of Psalm 67 once, slowly.

Tonight: *Write in your Promise Notebook three things that have come in during these forty days, large or small. Leave the rest of the page empty for tomorrow.*

DAY 40

Enter His Gates With Thanksgiving

When: Morning, on waking (about 7:00 am) · A quiet half hour during the day · Night, before sleep

The fortieth day has come. Today you read the whole of Psalm 100. It has only five verses. It is called "a Psalm of thanksgiving," and that is what today is for.

Read it slowly. Shout to the LORD. Serve Him with gladness. Know that He made us, and we are His. Enter His gates with thanksgiving. And then the last line, the one to carry out of these forty days: the LORD is good, His mercy endures forever, and His faithfulness to all generations.

"Serve the LORD with gladness." Not with worry, not with dread. With gladness. You began this program because something about money weighed on you. You end it by serving with gladness. That is not because every problem is solved. It is because you have learned, morning by morning, who opens His hand.

> *A Psalm of thanksgiving. Shout unto the LORD, all the earth.*
> *Serve the LORD with gladness; come before His presence with singing.*
> *Know ye that the LORD He is God; it is He that hath made us, and we are His, His people, and the flock of His pasture.*
> *Enter into His gates with thanksgiving, and into His courts with praise; give thanks unto Him, and bless His name.*
> *For the LORD is good; His mercy endureth for ever; and His faithfulness unto all generations. (Psalm 100)*

עִבְדוּ אֶת־יְהוָה בְּשִׂמְחָה

iv-DU et Adonai be-sim-CHAH

Serve the LORD with gladness.

Today, set aside half an hour. Sit by a window if you can, with your Promise Notebook. Read it from the first page to the last. Don't skip the hard entries. Read the worried nights next to the grateful ones. You will see the road you walked.

Then, on the empty page you left yesterday, write a thank-you to Hashem in your own words. Not a long one. A few honest lines.

THE ORDER OF THE DAY

Morning: read all of Psalm 100 aloud, twice. Say the Hebrew line three times. During the day: read your Promise Notebook from the first page to the last. On a fresh page, write a few lines of thanks to Hashem in your own words. Put a coin in your tzedakah box as a thank-offering. Night: read Psalm 100 one more time, and say: "His faithfulness is unto all generations."



On the fortieth day, read your notebook from the first page and give thanks.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

You finished. Whether every day went perfectly or not, you climbed the mountain. Close the notebook gently tonight, and thank Hashem for each step.

Tonight: *Write the last line of your forty days in the Promise Notebook: "His mercy endureth for ever." Then sign it with your name and today's date.*

AT THE END OF THE FORTY DAYS

- [ ] I read Psalm 100 aloud on the fortieth day.
- [ ] I read my Promise Notebook from the first page to the last.
- [ ] I wrote a page of thanks in my own words.
- [ ] My wallet card is still in my wallet.
- [ ] My tzedakah box has received something this week.
- [ ] I know which morning reading I will keep from Day 41 on.

Day 41 and After

Tomorrow morning you'll wake up and there won't be a new day in the book. What now?

Keep the morning. The single most important thing you've built in these forty days is the first minutes of your day. Before the phone, before the bank, before the news, you turn to Hashem. Don't let that go. Keep saying the morning decree you have said since the first seven days, and keep reading Psalm 145:16 with your mind on the words, the way the Shulchan Aruch teaches. You can choose one text from these forty days that spoke to you most and read it each morning along with it. Many readers will pick the verse they have on their wallet card.

Keep the three moments if you can: morning, a minute at midday, a few words at night. On a busy day, keep the morning at least. A short prayer said every day does more than a long one said once in a while. That is what the manna taught: bread each day, so the heart turns to the Father each day.

Repeat the forty days if you wish. Many people find that the second time through, the verses mean something new, because they themselves have changed. You can start again from Day 1 in the first book, or from Day 8 in this one. There is no rule against it. Moses himself went up the mountain for forty days a second time.

Keep giving. Keep your tzedakah box on the table. Keep the portion you chose on Day 34, a tenth if you can, less if you must, and never more than a fifth. Let your eye stay good toward others, glad at their good fortune.

And keep quiet. Don't count your blessing out loud. Don't show the world what is growing in your house. The Talmud teaches that blessing rests on what is hidden from the eye. Let it grow there, little by little, the way you gathered.

Keep your notebook, too. You don't have to write every night now. But when something comes in, a bill paid, a door opened, a calm night, write it down. One day you'll read it again, and you'll be glad you did.

Turn the page. Ahead you'll find the prayers for the hard days: the debt, the late bill, the house, the children, the check and the work. They are waiting for you whenever you need them.



PART TWO

Prayers for Every Situation

Some days the trouble has a name: a debt, a late bill, a worried child, a check that has to stretch to the end of the month. This part gives you a teaching, a spoken prayer and a few plain actions for each of those days, so you never have to wonder what to say.

CHAPTER 8

When the Debt Is Heavy

Debt is a weight you carry even in your sleep. It sits on the kitchen table in envelopes, and it sits on your chest when you wake at three in the morning. This chapter is for the day that weight feels too heavy to lift.

A widow, a creditor and one small pot

The Book of Kings tells of a woman whose husband had died. He had feared the LORD, but he left a debt behind him. Now the creditor was coming, and the law of that time let him take her two children as servants to work off what was owed.

She did not hide. She went to the prophet Elisha and cried out. Read what she said, because many readers of this book could say the same words today.

> *Now there cried a certain woman of the wives of the sons of the prophets unto Elisha, saying: 'Thy servant my husband is dead; and thou knowest that thy servant did fear the LORD; and the creditor is come to take unto him my two children to be bondmen.' (2 Kings 4:1)*

Notice what Elisha did not do. He did not give her a speech about money. He did not pay the debt for her. He asked her a question.

> *And Elisha said unto her: 'What shall I do for thee? tell me; what hast thou in the house?' And she said: 'Thy handmaid hath not any thing in the house, save a pot of oil.' (2 Kings 4:2)*

"What hast thou in the house?"

This is the first question of every debt prayer. Not "what do I lack?" but "what do I have?" The widow said she had nothing, and then, in the same breath, she named something: a pot of oil. It was small. It was all she had. And it was where the blessing began.

מַה־יֶּשׁ־לָךְ בַּבָּיִת

mah yesh-LACH ba-BA-yit

What do you have in the house?

Elisha told her to borrow empty vessels from all her neighbors, and "borrow not a few." Then she was to go inside, shut the door behind her and her sons, and pour. She poured, and the oil kept coming. It filled every vessel she had gathered.

> *And it came to pass, when the vessels were full, that she said unto her son: 'Bring me yet a vessel.' And he said unto her: 'There is not a vessel more.' And the oil stayed. (2 Kings 4:6)*

The oil stopped when the vessels ran out, not before. Think about that slowly. The blessing was measured by what she was ready to receive. She had to go out, knock on doors, ask, carry and prepare. Then she had to close the door and act in private.

Sell the oil and pay the debt

The story does not end with a full house of oil. It ends with a plan.

> *Then she came and told the man of God. And he said: 'Go, sell the oil, and pay thy debt, and live thou and thy sons of the rest.' (2 Kings 4:7)*

There is an order here. First, pay the debt. Then live on what remains. The prophet did not tell her to keep the oil and hope the creditor would forget. He told her to sell it and pay. The miracle came to her through work, and it went straight to the debt.

That is the spirit of this chapter. You pray, and you also face the papers. You ask Hashem for help, and you also count what you owe. Faith and order walk together.

What the Book of Proverbs says about borrowing

King Solomon put it plainly.

> *The rich ruleth over the poor, And the borrower is servant to the lender. (Proverbs 22:7)*

That is not an insult. It is a description. Anyone who has carried a large balance knows the feeling: someone else has a claim on your month before it even begins. The Torah's picture of a blessed life is the opposite.

> *The LORD will open unto thee His good treasure the heaven to give the rain of thy land in its season, and to bless all the work of thy hand; and thou shalt lend unto many nations, but thou shalt not borrow. (Deuteronomy 28:12)*

וְעֶבֶד לֹוֶה לְאִישׁ מַלְוֶה

ve-E-ved lo-VEH le-ISH mal-VEH

The borrower is servant to the lender.

The goal of the Torah is a person who is free, who serves Hashem and not a lender. You may be far from that today. That is all right. The widow was far from it too. She started with one pot.

In the first seven days you already said the Torah's order about releasing debts from Deuteronomy 15. Keep saying it. This chapter adds the work of the hands to that word.

Write it all down, the smallest first

Fear grows in the dark. A debt you do not look at grows larger in your mind than it is on paper. So the first act of faith is to put it on paper.

Take one sheet. Write down every debt you have: the card, the loan, the medical bill, the money you owe a relative. Next to each one, write what you owe and the smallest payment due. Then put them in order, from the smallest balance to the largest.

Why the smallest first? Because the widow started with what was small. When you finish paying a small debt, you cross it off with your own hand, and you see with your own eyes that a debt can end. That line through a name on the page is a small thanksgiving. Say "thank You, Hashem" out loud when you draw it.

Keep paying the smallest required amount on all of them. Put whatever extra you can spare toward the smallest one. When it is gone, move to the next.



Before you open them, put your hand on them and pray.

A prayer before you open the envelope

Many people cannot open a statement without their stomach turning. So do not open it in a rush, standing at the mailbox. Bring it inside. Sit down. Put your hand on it. Pray first, then open.

This is not a ritual from the Talmud. It is the practice of this program, and it rests on something the tradition does teach: that you turn your heart to Hashem before you deal with the work of your hands. You do not want to meet a number in a panic. You want to meet it calm, already in the presence of the One who feeds every living thing.

THE PRAYER

Sit down with the envelope in front of you. Put your right hand on it. Say slowly: "Master of the world, You asked the widow, 'What do you have in the house?' Here is what I have. I have this debt, and I have this day, and I have my two hands. I am not hiding from what I owe. Give me a clear mind to read this paper, and the strength to pay what I can. Open Your good treasure over the work of my hands, as You promised, so that I may lend and not borrow. Let the oil not stop while I still have vessels. And bring me, step by step, to the day I am free to serve only You. Amen." Then open the envelope, read it, and write the number on your sheet.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

Don't wait until you feel strong to look at the numbers. Look at them first, and the strength comes after. One sheet of paper and one honest prayer will do more than a month of worry.

Shut the door and pour

Elisha gave the widow one more instruction that is easy to miss. She was to go inside and shut the door upon herself and her sons, and pour in private. The neighbors lent the vessels, but they did not watch the oil flow.

There is a lesson here for anyone working through debt. You do not need to tell the whole street what you owe, or announce each payment you make. Work quietly. Pay quietly. Let the progress be between you, your household and Hashem. In the first seven days you learned to keep certain things hidden from the eye. The widow's closed door is the same wisdom.

It also means you can stop comparing. The neighbor's new car, the cousin who seems to have no worries: you do not know what is behind their door. Behind yours, the oil is flowing as long as you bring vessels.

Every vessel counts

Each payment you make is a vessel. Each bill you call about is a vessel. Each dollar you do not spend on something you do not need is a vessel. The widow's son kept bringing them, one after another, until there were no more.

Some weeks you will bring only one small cup. That is still a vessel. Do not despise a small payment. The story is clear: the oil did not stop because the vessels were small. It stopped only when there were none left.

When you have nothing to sell

Some readers will say: "I don't even have a pot of oil." Look again. The widow thought she had nothing too. You may have time. You may have a skill, a thing you no longer use, a neighbor who would help if asked. Elisha told her to borrow vessels from her neighbors. She had to let people know she needed them.

Asking is not shameful. Shutting the door and pouring is not shameful. Selling the oil is not shameful. The only thing the story warns against is doing nothing while the creditor walks toward the door.

STEP BY STEP

1. Take one sheet of paper and list every debt you owe, with the balance and the smallest payment due.
2. Number them from the smallest balance to the largest.

3. Ask yourself, in writing, "What do I have in the house?" Write at least three things.
4. Pay the smallest payment on every debt; put any extra toward debt number one.
5. Say the prayer above before you open any statement this month.
6. Draw a line through each debt you finish, and say "thank You, Hashem" out loud.

BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

- [ ] I have read the story of the widow and the oil (2 Kings 4:1-7).
- [ ] I have written every debt on one sheet, smallest first.
- [ ] I have written what I have in the house.
- [ ] I said the prayer with my hand on an envelope.
- [ ] I know which debt I will finish first.

CHAPTER 9

When a Bill Is Past Due

The notice came. The amount is in red, or the word "overdue" is printed at the top. Maybe the phone is ringing with a number you do not want to answer. This chapter is for that morning.

The first thing to know

A past-due bill feels like a judge's verdict. It is not. It is a piece of paper with a date on it. People call about it, plans are made about it, and most of all, Hashem sees it before you do.

The Psalmist did not pretend trouble away. He named it, and then he named his help.

> *God is our refuge and strength, A very present help in trouble. (Psalm 46:2)*

A reminder you already know: in this book, verse numbers follow the Hebrew Bible, so in some English Bibles this verse is Psalm 46:1.

"A very present help." Not a help that comes later, after the trouble is over. A help found in the middle of it. The Hebrew says it is "found very much" in troubles.

עֶזְרָה בְצָרוֹת נִמְצָא מְאֹד

ez-RAH ve-tza-ROT nim-TZA me-OD

A help in troubles, found very near.

Fear is not a sin

Some readers feel guilty for being afraid. They think faith means feeling nothing. But look at the Psalms. The men who wrote them were afraid, and they said so. Then they turned the fear into a prayer.

That is your task when the red notice comes. Don't pretend. Say to Hashem, "I am afraid of this bill." Then say the verse. The fear names the trouble, and the verse names the help.

Lift your eyes before you lift the phone

Psalm 121 is called a Song of Ascents. It was sung going up, climbing toward Jerusalem. It begins with a man looking up at the mountains and asking a question.

> *A Song of Ascents. I will lift up mine eyes unto the mountains: From whence shall my help come? My help cometh from the LORD, Who made heaven and earth. (Psalm 121:1-2)*

He asks the question honestly. He does not already have the answer in his pocket. Then he answers it: my help comes from the LORD. Not from the mountains, not from the bank, not from the person on the other end of the line. Those may be the hands that help, but the help itself comes from the Maker of heaven and earth.

Before you make a hard call, do what the Psalmist did. Lift your eyes. Ask the question out loud. Give the answer out loud.

Cast the burden

> *Cast thy burden upon the LORD, and He will sustain thee; He will never suffer the righteous to be moved. (Psalm 55:23)*

The Hebrew word for "sustain" here comes from the same root as the word for providing food and support. Hashem does not only lift the burden off you. He carries you.

הַשְׁלֵךְ עַל־יְהוָה יְהָבְךָ וְהוּא יְכַלְכְּלֶךָ

hash-LECH al Adonai ye-hav-CHA ve-HU ye-chal-ke-LE-cha

Cast your burden on the LORD, and He will sustain you.

Casting a burden is an act. You throw it. You open your hand and let it go. That is what you do in prayer. Then you pick up the phone with empty hands, because the weight is already with Him.

A handful of meal and a little oil

In a year of drought, the prophet Elijah came to a widow in Zarephath and asked for bread. Hear her answer.

> *And she said: 'As the LORD thy God liveth, I have not a cake, only a handful of meal in the jar, and a little oil in the cruse; and, behold, I am gathering two sticks, that I may go in and dress it for me and my son, that we may eat it, and die.' (1 Kings 17:12)*

She was at the very bottom. Elijah told her not to be afraid, to make him a little cake first, and then to make for herself and her son. And then he gave her the word of the LORD.

> *For thus saith the LORD, the God of Israel: The jar of meal shall not be spent, neither shall the cruse of oil fail, until the day that the LORD sendeth rain upon the land.' (1 Kings 17:14)*

> *And she went and did according to the saying of Elijah; and she, and he, and her house, did eat many days. (1 Kings 17:15)*

Look at the words "many days." Not a mountain of flour. A jar that did not run out, one day at a time, until the rain came. That is often how help comes to a person with a past-due bill. Not all at once, but enough for today, and again enough for tomorrow.

Call before the date, not after

Here is the practical side, and it matters as much as the prayer.

If you know a bill will be late, call before the due date. Most companies would rather hear from you than chase you. Tell them the truth: "I want to pay this. I can't pay all of it on the date. What can we do?" Ask whether they have a payment plan, a hardship program, or a new due date that fits the day your money arrives.

Write down the name of the person you spoke to, the date, and what they told you. Keep that paper with the bill.

If the bill is already late, call anyway. The widow of Zarephath did not hide her empty jar. She said exactly what she had. Do the same. Honesty spoken calmly opens more doors than silence.

The prayer before the phone call

This prayer is the practice of this program. It is not a custom from the Sages; it is a way of doing what the Psalms teach in a moment you will face. Say it with the bill in front of you and the phone beside it.

THE PRAYER

Put the bill on the table and the phone next to it. Lift your eyes and say: "I lift up my eyes. Where will my help come from? My help comes from Hashem, who made heaven and earth. Master of the world, I cast this burden on You, and I trust You to sustain me. You kept the jar of flour full for the widow, one day at a time. Keep my jar full for today. Put the right words in my mouth on this call. Let me speak the truth, without fear and without shame. Put kindness in the heart of the person who answers. Let us find a way that I can keep. And whatever they say, I know my help does not come from them. It comes from You. Amen." Then make the call.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

The call you are dreading usually takes ten minutes. The fear before it can take ten days. Pray, dial, and get it behind you.

What to say on the call

Many people freeze when the person answers. It helps to have your words ready on a slip of paper. Keep it short and true.

Say who you are and which account you are calling about. Say that you want to pay. Say what you can pay and on which date. Then ask one question: "What options do you have for someone in my situation?" Listen. Write down what they say before you answer.

Do not promise a payment you cannot make. A broken promise makes the next call harder. A small promise you keep makes the next call easier. The widow of Zarephath gave what she had, a little cake, and no more. She did not pretend her jar was full.

Rain is coming

The widow's jar did not run out "until the day that the LORD sendeth rain upon the land." The drought had an end. Your hard month has an end too. You do not know the date, and this book will not give you one. But the verse teaches that the jar holds until the rain.

So when you hang up the phone, do not sit in the fear. Stand up. Do the next thing on your list. Wash a dish, write a note, step outside. The help you prayed for is already on its way in the way Hashem chooses.

When the call goes badly

Sometimes the answer is no. The person is short with you, or the company will not bend. That does not mean the prayer failed. Write down what was said. Thank Hashem that you faced it. Then ask: who else can I call? Is there a supervisor, a local program, a family member, a neighbor?

The widow of Zarephath did not get a sack of flour. She got a jar that kept giving. Some help comes in small pieces from many places. Keep your eyes up and keep gathering.

STEP BY STEP

1. Write the due date and the amount of every bill this month on one page.
2. Mark any bill you cannot pay in full on time.
3. Call about each marked bill before its due date and ask for a plan.
4. Say the prayer above before every one of these calls.
5. Write down the name, the date and the agreement after each call, and keep it with the bill.
6. At night, say Psalm 121:1-2 once more, out loud, before you sleep.

BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

- [ ] I have read Psalm 46:2, Psalm 121:1-2 and Psalm 55:23.
- [ ] I have read the story of the widow of Zarephath (1 Kings 17:12-16).
- [ ] I know which bills are late or will be late.

- [ ] I have made, or set a time to make, each call before the due date.
- [ ] I said the prayer before the phone call.

CHAPTER 10

For Your House

A house is more than walls and a roof. It is where you rest, where you eat, where you are yourself. When money is tight, the house is where you feel it first: in the repair you put off, the payment that worries you, the quiet at the table. This chapter is a prayer over your home.

Who builds the house

> *A Song of Ascents; of Solomon. Except the LORD build the house, They labour in vain that build it; Except the LORD keep the city, The watchman waketh but in vain. (Psalm 127:1)*

This verse does not tell the builder to stay home. It tells him who the real builder is. You still lay the bricks. You still pay the bills and fix the leak. But if Hashem is not the one building, all that work is like pouring water into sand.

אִם־יְהוָה לֹא־יִבְנֶה בַּיִת

im Adonai lo yiv-NEH VA-yit

Unless the LORD builds the house.

The next verse speaks to anyone who has stayed up late worrying about the house.

> *It is vain for you that ye rise early, and sit up late, Ye that eat the bread of toil; So He giveth unto His beloved in sleep. (Psalm 127:2)*

"He gives to His beloved in sleep." The worry you carry at midnight does not add a single board to your house. Hashem keeps working while you rest. You are allowed to sleep.

Rest is part of the blessing

Many people who carry money worries also carry guilt about resting. They feel they must always be doing something. Psalm 127 frees you from that. Hashem gives to His beloved in sleep. Rest is not laziness when you have done your part. It is trust.

So when the day's work is done and the bills for today are paid or planned, go to bed. Say the verse, close your eyes, and let the Builder of the house keep working.

Wisdom builds, knowledge fills

Solomon also wrote this.

> *Through wisdom is a house builded; And by understanding it is established; And by knowledge are the chambers filled With all precious and pleasant riches. (Proverbs 24:3-4)*

There are three steps here. Wisdom builds the house. Understanding makes it firm. Knowledge fills its rooms. A house is built well when the people in it think before they act, know what they have, and treat what they have with care.

For your home, this means simple things. Know what comes in and what goes out each month. Know what needs fixing first. Know what you already own before you buy more. That is "knowledge" in the plain sense, and Proverbs says it fills the rooms.

The word on the door

The Torah tells us to write its words on the doorposts.

> *And thou shalt write them upon the door-posts of thy house, and upon thy gates. (Deuteronomy 6:9)*

This is the mezuzah. On a small parchment a scribe writes words of the Torah, beginning with the Shema, and the parchment is fixed to the doorpost of a Jewish home. Every time you go out and every time you come in, you pass the words "Hear, O Israel: The LORD our God, the LORD is One."

וּכְתַבְתָּם עַל־מְזוּזוֹת בֵּיתֶךָ

u-che-tav-TAM al me-zu-ZOT bei-TE-cha

Write them on the doorposts of your house.

Whether or not you have a mezuzah, the lesson belongs to every reader: the door of your house is a place to remember who keeps the house. Pause at your door. Remember.



Every time you go out and every time you come in.

The blessing in the house

The Talmud, in tractate Bava Metzia, page 59a, teaches through Rabbi Helbo that a man must always be careful to honor his wife, because blessing is found in a man's home only on account of her. The Sages read this from Abraham: the Torah says Abraham was treated well "for her sake," for Sarah's sake. On the same page, Rava told the people of his town to honor their wives so that they would become rich.

Read that again slowly. The Sages tied the blessing of the house not to its size or its price, but to honor between the people who live there. Kind words at the table, respect in a hard conversation, thanks for what the other person does. Those are not small things. The Talmud treats them as the doorway of blessing.

> **LIVING ALONE**
>
> Many readers of this book are widowed or live alone. The teaching is still yours. Honor the memory of the one you loved, and speak of them with kindness in your home. Honor the people who come through your door: a child, a grandchild, a friend, a neighbor. And honor your own home: keep it with care, as a place where Hashem's name is remembered. The blessing of a house follows honor, and honor can live in any home.

Peace before payments

When money is short, homes become tense. Words get sharp. One person blames the other for the bill. Before you pray for the mortgage or the rent, pray for peace inside the walls. The Talmud's teaching suggests the order: honor first, and blessing follows.

If you share your home with a spouse, choose one evening this week to sit down together with the bills. Begin with a word of thanks to each other. Then look at the numbers. Do not let money speak louder than love at your table.

THE PRAYER

Stand at your front door, or touch your mezuzah if you have one. Say: "Master of the world, unless You build this house, we work in vain. Build it. You give to Your beloved even in sleep; let me rest in this house and not lie awake with worry. Fill these rooms with wisdom, with understanding and with knowledge, and fill them with what is precious and pleasant. Keep this roof over my head and keep the door of this house open to kindness. Let honor live here, and let Your blessing come in because of it. Guard my going out and my coming in, from now and forever. Amen."



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

You can't always change the size of your house. You can always change the tone of it. Start with the words spoken inside it.

Guarding the going out and the coming in

Psalm 121, which you met in the last chapter, ends with a verse that belongs at every door.

> *The LORD shall guard thy going out and thy coming in, From this time forth and for ever. (Psalm 121:8)*

Going out and coming in is the whole life of a house. You go out to work, to the store, to the doctor. You come in tired, or worried, or glad. Each time you cross the threshold, you can say this verse quietly. It takes five seconds. Over a month it becomes a wall of prayer around your home.

When the house itself is the worry

Some readers are afraid of losing the house: a mortgage behind, a rent increase, a landlord who wants them out. If that is you, pray this chapter's prayer every day, and also do the plain work. Call the lender or the landlord early, as Chapter 9 teaches.

Write down every conversation. Ask what help exists for people in your position.

Remember that the first verse of Psalm 127 does not say "unless the LORD buys the house." It says "unless the LORD builds the house." A house is built of people and peace as much as of wood. Whatever happens with the walls, Hashem can build your home.

A house in order

Order in a house is a kind of prayer you do with your hands. A clean table, a drawer for the bills, a place for the house keys. These are not magic. But they make room, and the Psalm says the One who builds the house is already at work. Give Him a house ready to be filled.

STEP BY STEP

1. Read Psalm 127:1-2 out loud at your front door once this week.
2. Choose one drawer or folder for every paper that belongs to the house, and put them all there.
3. Write a short list: what the house costs each month, and the one repair that matters most.
4. Say one word of honor or thanks to someone in your home each day, or speak kindly of someone you have lost.
5. If you share your home, sit down together with the bills one evening, and begin with thanks.
6. Say the prayer above before you pay the rent or the mortgage.

BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

- [ ] I have read Psalm 127:1-2 and Proverbs 24:3-4.
- [ ] I have paused at my door and remembered Deuteronomy 6:9.
- [ ] I know the teaching of Bava Metzia 59a about honor and blessing in the home.
- [ ] My house papers are in one place.
- [ ] I said the prayer for my house.

CHAPTER 11

For Your Children and Grandchildren

You can pay your own bills, but you cannot carry your children's lives for them. You worry about their jobs, their marriages, their debts, the world their own children will grow up in. This chapter gives you the oldest words of blessing in the Torah, and a way to say them.

The blessing Jacob gave

Near the end of his life, Jacob called his son Joseph and Joseph's two sons, Ephraim and Manasseh. These boys were his grandchildren, born in Egypt, far from the land of their fathers. Jacob placed his hands on their heads and blessed them.

> *And he blessed them that day, saying: 'By thee shall Israel bless, saying: God make thee as Ephraim and as Manasseh.' And he set Ephraim before Manasseh. (Genesis 48:20)*

Jacob did not only bless them. He said that all Israel would use their names to bless. "By thee shall Israel bless." And it came true. Many Jewish parents bless their children on Friday night with these words.

יְשִׂמְךָ אֱלֹהִים כְּאֶפְרַיִם וְכִמְנַשֶּׁה

ye-sim-CHA e-lo-HIM ke-ef-RA-yim ve-chim-na-SHEH

May God make you like Ephraim and Manasseh.

Notice something: the first blessing of this kind in the Torah was given by a grandfather to his grandchildren. If you have grandchildren, these words are especially yours.

Why Ephraim and Manasseh

Why these two, and not Abraham or Moses? The Torah does not say outright, but look at their story. They were born and raised in a foreign land, in the house of power in Egypt, and they kept the name of Israel. They were brothers, and Jacob set the younger before the older, and still the Torah tells of no quarrel between them over it.

That is a blessing every grandparent wants: that the children keep who they are wherever they live, and that they live in peace with one another.

Taught of the LORD

The prophet Isaiah gave a promise about children.

> *And all thy children shall be taught of the LORD; and great shall be the peace of thy children. (Isaiah 54:13)*

The prophet joins two things: being taught of the LORD, and great peace. A child who knows Hashem has something no bank can give. You may not be able to teach your grown children anything anymore. They may not listen. But you can pray that Hashem Himself will teach them. That prayer is never too late.

וְרַב שְׁלוֹם בָּנָיִךְ

ve-RAV she-LOM ba-NA-yich

And great shall be the peace of your children.

An inheritance for children's children

> *A good man leaveth an inheritance to his children's children; And the wealth of the sinner is laid up for the righteous. (Proverbs 13:22)*

Proverbs speaks of grandchildren, not only children. A good person thinks two generations ahead. That inheritance may be money. It may be a house, or a little set aside. But it is also a name, a way of living, a habit of prayer and giving that the children saw in you.

Many readers live on a small fixed income and fear they will leave nothing. Do not measure your inheritance only in dollars. A grandchild who remembers that you blessed them with your hands on their head has received something real. A grandchild who saw you give a coin to tzedakah before you paid your own bills has learned something no school teaches.



By thee shall Israel bless.

How to bless a child or grandchild

You do not need to be a rabbi to bless your children. Jacob was a father and a grandfather. You can be the same.

If the child is with you, place your hands, or one hand, gently on their head. If they are far away, hold their picture or simply say their name. You can bless a grown child, a married child, a grandchild who lives across the country. Hashem hears the blessing wherever they are.

Say the words of Genesis 48:20 for a son: "May God make you like Ephraim and Manasseh." Then add your own words in plain English. Name what you hope for them: health, a good livelihood, peace in their home, faith.

THE PRAYER

Hold your hands over the child's head, or hold their photograph, and say their name. Then say: "May God make you like Ephraim and Manasseh. Master of the world, this is my child. I cannot walk every road with them, but You can. Teach them Yourself, as Your prophet promised, and let great be their peace. Give them honest work and enough bread, a home with peace inside it, and people around them who love them. Let them keep who they are wherever they live. Let them live in peace with their brothers and sisters. And let me leave them an inheritance of a good name, a little set aside, and a memory of prayer. Amen."



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

Your children may roll their eyes when you bless them. Bless them anyway. They will remember your hands long after they forget the eye-roll.

A blessing that goes both ways

Jacob's blessing was given with his hands on the boys' heads. There is something in that touch. A child, even a grown one, feels the weight of a parent's hands differently from any words on a phone. If you can, let the blessing be physical: a hand on the

head, a hand on the shoulder, a hand held.

And let it go both ways. Ask your children and grandchildren to pray for you, too. Older people often think they must be the only ones giving. But when a grandchild prays for a grandparent, the child learns that prayer is for the people we love, and the grandparent is carried. Psalm 71 asks Hashem not to forsake us in old age until we have declared His strength to the next generation. Blessing your grandchildren is exactly that.

For daughters and granddaughters

Jacob's words name two boys, but the prayer behind them is for every child. When you bless a daughter or a granddaughter, use the same moment and the same hands, and say the words of Isaiah over her: may she be taught of the LORD, and may her peace be great. Then add what you hope for her in your own words.

Do not worry about getting the form exactly right. Jacob did not read his blessing from a card. He spoke from his heart, with his hands on their heads, and the Torah kept his words for every generation after him. Your words, spoken with love, are kept by Hashem too.

The table as a classroom

Isaiah says the children will be "taught of the LORD." Very often the first place they are taught is a kitchen table. When your grandchildren eat with you, let them hear you thank Hashem for the food. Let them see the tzedakah box and drop a coin in it. Let them hear you say a verse from the Psalms when something goes wrong.

You do not need to give a lesson. Children learn what they see. A grandparent who prays quietly, gives quietly and speaks kindly is teaching the whole time.

When a child is in trouble

Some readers are praying for a child who is in debt, out of work, or far from home in every sense. Do not stop praying for them because they do not ask you to. Do not stop because they seem far from Hashem. Isaiah's promise is for "all thy children."

Pray for them by name every day. And, where you can, help without carrying them. Sometimes the best help is a word of blessing and a door that stays open, not a check that leaves you with a debt of your own. Remember the order the Sages set for giving: do not give away so much that you come to need others. That applies inside a family too.

STEP BY STEP

1. Write the names of your children and grandchildren on a single page and keep it in your Psalter or your Promise Notebook.
2. Choose one evening a week, Friday night if you can, to bless them.
3. Say the words of Genesis 48:20 over each child, in person or by name.
4. Add one sentence in your own words for each one.
5. Read Isaiah 54:13 aloud for any child who is far from you or in trouble.
6. Decide one small thing you will leave as an inheritance this year, even a letter in your own hand.

BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

- [ ] I have read Genesis 48:20, Isaiah 54:13 and Proverbs 13:22.
- [ ] I have the names of my children and grandchildren written down.
- [ ] I have blessed at least one of them this week.
- [ ] I have chosen a regular evening for the blessing.
- [ ] I know what small inheritance I am building.

CHAPTER 12

For the Retirement Check

The check comes on the same day every month. You know the amount by heart. And you know, too, how quickly it goes: rent, food, medicine, the bills. This chapter is for the day the check arrives, and for every day of the month that follows.

A prayer the Bible wrote for you

Many people feel that old age is a time of being set aside. The world moves fast, prices rise, and the body is slower than it was. The Psalmist knew that feeling, and he did not hide it from Hashem.

> *Cast me not off in the time of old age; When my strength faileth, forsake me not. (Psalm 71:9)*

This is a prayer the Bible wrote for you. You can pray it word for word. You are allowed to tell Hashem that you are afraid of being forgotten.

אַל־תַּשְׁלִיכֵנִי לְעֵת זִקְנָה

al tash-li-CHE-ni le-ET zik-NAH

Do not cast me off in the time of old age.

A little later in the same Psalm, the prayer turns.

> *And even unto old age and hoary hairs, O God, forsake me not; Until I have declared Thy strength unto the next generation, Thy might to every one that is to come. (Psalm 71:18)*

He gives a reason for wanting to stay strong: so he can tell the next generation about Hashem. Your later years have a purpose. You are the one who remembers, who can tell your grandchildren what Hashem has done. That is not a small job.

Still bearing fruit

Psalm 92 is the Psalm for the Sabbath day. Near the end it speaks about the old.

> *The righteous shall flourish like the palm-tree; He shall grow like a cedar in Lebanon. Planted in the house of the LORD, They shall flourish in the courts of our God. They shall still bring forth fruit in old age; They shall be full of sap and richness; To declare that the LORD is upright, My Rock, in whom there is no unrighteousness. (Psalm 92:13-16)*

"They shall still bring forth fruit in old age." The palm and the cedar are trees that last a long time. The Psalm does not promise that you will feel young. It promises that you can still bear fruit.

עוֹד יְנוּבוּן בְּשֵׂיבָה

od ye-nu-VUN be-sei-VAH

They will still bear fruit in old age.

"I will carry you"

Through the prophet Isaiah, Hashem made one of the tenderest promises in the whole Bible.

> *Even to old age I am the same, and even to hoar hairs will I carry you; I have made, and I will bear; yea, I will carry, and will deliver. (Isaiah 46:4)*

Read it slowly. "I have made, and I will bear." The One who made you does not lose interest in you when your hair turns white. He says He will carry you. Not your children, not the government, not the bank. He says "I."

The check that comes each month is one of the ways Hashem carries you. It came through years of your work, through a system you paid into, through people you will never meet. Receive it as a gift from His hand, through those hands.

Bread in the basket today

The Talmud, in tractate Sotah, page 48b, brings a teaching of Rabbi Eliezer the Great: a person who has bread in his basket today and says, "What will I eat tomorrow?" is among those of little faith.

That is hard to hear when the check has to last thirty days. But listen to what he is really saying. He is not telling you to stop planning. He is telling you not to let tomorrow's fear eat today's bread. When the check arrives, you have bread in the basket. Thank Hashem for today. Plan for tomorrow with a pencil, not with panic.

Glad with your portion

The Mishnah, in Pirkei Avot, chapter 4, teaches through Ben Zoma: who is rich? The one who is glad with his portion. He brings the verse from Psalm 128: when you eat the labour of your hands, happy shall you be.

The check may be smaller than you wish. Being glad with it does not mean pretending it is enough for everything. It means seeing it as a portion given to you, and thanking Hashem for it before you count what it lacks.

A prayer on the day the check arrives

Make the day the check comes a small day of thanks. This is the practice of this program. Before you spend any of it, before you pay a single bill, stop and pray. You are telling Hashem, and yourself, that this money came from Him.

THE PRAYER

On the day the check or deposit arrives, before you spend any of it, sit down and say: "Master of the world, You said, 'Even to old age I am the same, and even to gray hair I will carry you.' Today You carried me. Thank You for this money. Thank You for the years of work that earned it, and for every hand that brought it to me. Do not cast me off in old age. When my strength fails, do not leave me. Let this money cover what I need this month: my home, my food, my medicine. Let it stretch where it must. Let me give a little from it with a good eye, and let me still bear fruit, so that I can tell my children and grandchildren that You are faithful. I have bread in my basket today, and I trust You for tomorrow. Amen."



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

The day the check comes, pray before you pay. Thirty seconds of thanks will change how you spend the other twenty-nine days.

Giving from a fixed income

You may ask: how can I give tzedakah when I am counting every dollar? The tradition answers with care.

The Shulchan Aruch, in Yoreh De'ah, section 249, paragraph 1, teaches that the finest way is to give a fifth of what one has, a tenth is the middle way, and a person should not give more than a fifth while alive. The Talmud, in tractate Ketubot, page 50a, tells that the Sages gathered in the town of Usha set that same limit: no one should give away more than a fifth, so that he does not come to need help from others himself.

Look at that. The tradition sets a ceiling, not only a goal. It protects you from giving away what you need to live. Nobody in the Torah's eyes should go hungry or miss the rent to give.

So begin where you are. If a tenth would leave you short, set aside less. Set aside a coin in the tzedakah box on the day the check comes, as you did in the first seven days. A coin given with a good eye is a real gift. As your situation allows, you can grow toward the tenth. You never need to go past the fifth.

When the money runs short before the month does

There may be a week near the end of the month when the check is gone. On those days, go back to Rabbi Eliezer's teaching. Do you have bread in the basket today? Then today is covered. Thank Hashem for today, and ask Him for tomorrow.

Then do one practical thing. Look at your one-page plan and find where the money went. Was it a bill you did not expect? A medicine? A gift you could not afford? Write it down. Next month, you will plan for it. That is not a lack of faith. That is what Proverbs calls knowledge filling the rooms.

The gift of time

Your later years may have less money than your working years, but they often have more time. Time is something you can give. You can visit a neighbor who is alone, call a friend in the hospital, read the Psalms with a grandchild, help at your synagogue or community. The Psalmist asked to stay strong "until I have declared Thy strength unto the next generation." Giving your time is one way of declaring it.

Planning the month

Once you have prayed and given, take a pencil. Write the amount of the check at the top of a page. Below it, write what must be paid first: home, food, medicine, heat. Then what can wait. Then what is left. You do not need a large budget book. One page a month is enough.

> **STEP BY STEP**

1. Mark on your calendar the day each check or deposit arrives.
2. On that day, say the prayer above before you spend anything.
3. Put a coin, or whatever you have set as your measure, in the tzedakah box that same day; never more than a fifth.
4. Write a one-page plan: the amount at the top, then what must be paid first, then the rest.
5. Read Psalm 92:13-16 aloud on the Sabbath, or on any day you feel old and tired.
6. Tell one child or grandchild this month about something Hashem has done for you.

BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

- [ ] I have read Psalm 71:9, Psalm 71:18, Psalm 92:13-16 and Isaiah 46:4.
- [ ] I know Rabbi Eliezer's teaching about bread in the basket (Sotah 48b).
- [ ] I know the tradition's limit on giving: no more than a fifth.
- [ ] I have marked the day my check arrives.
- [ ] I have said the prayer for the retirement check at least once.

CHAPTER 13

For Your Work and Business

Maybe you still work, full time or a few hours a week. Maybe you have a small business, a craft you sell, or a garden that brings in a little. Or maybe your work is now in your home and your family. Whatever your hands do, this chapter asks Hashem to bless it, and shows the one thing the Sages said to do before you count.

Who gives the power

Moses warned Israel about a danger that comes not in poverty but in success.

> *and thou say in thy heart: 'My power and the might of my hand hath gotten me this wealth.' But thou shalt remember the LORD thy God, for it is He that giveth thee power to get wealth, that He may establish His covenant which He swore unto thy fathers, as it is this day. (Deuteronomy 8:17-18)*

You worked. You got up early. You learned your trade. All of that is true. But who gave you the strength in your arms and the clarity in your mind? The Torah says it plainly: He gives you the power.

הוּא הַנֹּתֵן לְךָ כֹּחַ לַעֲשׂוֹת חָיִל

HU ha-no-**TEN** le-**CHA KO**-ach la-a-**SOT CHA**-yil

He is the One who gives you the power to make wealth.

This is not only a warning for the rich. It is comfort for the tired. If the power to work comes from Hashem, then you can ask Him for it. On the day you have no strength, the source is still there.

Blessing on all you put your hand to

> *The LORD will command the blessing with thee in thy barns, and in all that thou puttest thy hand unto; and He will bless thee in the land which the LORD thy God giveth thee. (Deuteronomy 28:8)*

"All that thou puttest thy hand unto." The Torah does not say Hashem will bless you while you sit still. It says He will bless what you put your hand to. You put out the hand; He commands the blessing into it.

Joseph in a stranger's house

Joseph was sold as a slave into Egypt. He had no family, no money and no rights. And yet the Torah says this.

> *And the LORD was with Joseph, and he was a prosperous man; and he was in the house of his master the Egyptian. And his master saw that the LORD was with him, and that the LORD made all that he did to prosper in his hand. (Genesis 39:2-3)*

Joseph worked in another man's house, under another man's orders. His work was not his own business. Still, Hashem made it prosper, and even his master could see it. If you work for someone else, at a job that is not your dream, this verse is yours. Blessing can rest on work done for others, in a place you did not choose.

Establish the work of our hands

Psalm 90 is called a prayer of Moses. It ends with a request every worker can make.

> *And let the graciousness of the Lord our God be upon us; Establish Thou also upon us the work of our hands; Yea, the work of our hands establish Thou it. (Psalm 90:17)*

Moses asks twice: establish the work of our hands. Make it firm. Make it last. Do not let it be built and then fall apart.

וּמַעֲשֵׂה יָדֵינוּ כּוֹנְנָה עָלֵינוּ

u-ma-a-SEH ya-DEI-nu ko-ne-NAH a-LEI-nu

Establish the work of our hands for us.

And through Isaiah, Hashem promises to be your teacher in business.

> *Thus saith the LORD, thy Redeemer, The Holy One of Israel: I am the LORD thy God, Who teacheth thee for thy profit, Who leadeth thee by the way that thou shouldest go. (Isaiah 48:17)*

"Who teacheth thee for thy profit." Ask Hashem to teach you: which job to take, which customer to trust, what price is fair, when to stop. He says He leads in the way you should go.

Your work is a calling

The Torah calls it "the work of thy hand," and the Psalm calls it "the work of our hands." Hands are personal. No one else has your hands, your skill, your way of doing things. Whatever your work is, from cleaning floors to keeping books to running a shop, it is a place where Hashem's blessing can rest.

So do your work as someone who is being watched over, not as someone who is alone. Begin with a word of prayer, work honestly, and end with thanks. Joseph's master could see that the LORD was with him. Let your work show the same thing.

Pray before you count

Now the teaching that sets this chapter apart.

The Talmud, in tractate Taanit, page 8b, teaches that a person who goes to measure the grain on his threshing floor should first pray, asking that it be Hashem's will to send blessing on the work of our hands. If he has already measured and only then prays, that prayer is in vain. The Sages explain why: blessing is not found in a thing that has been weighed, measured or counted, but only in a thing that is hidden from the eye.

Think about what this means for your work. Before you open the register, before you count the day's sales, before you look at the business account, pray. Ask for blessing while the number is still unknown. Do not count first and then ask Hashem to change it.

> **WHY "HIDDEN FROM THE EYE"**
> The Sages teach that blessing rests on what is still hidden. Once you have counted, the amount is fixed; you have measured it. Before you count, it is still open to blessing. This is also why the program asks you to keep your giving and your plans quiet, as you practiced in the first seven days. What is not shown off is not exposed to the eye.



Pray before you open the book.

The prayer before the work and before the count

Say this prayer at the start of the work day, or before you sit down to count what came in. This wording is the program's, written for you in plain English. The idea of asking for blessing before measuring comes straight from the Talmud.

THE PRAYER

Before you open the ledger, the register or the account, put your hand on it and say: "May it be Your will, Hashem my God, that You send blessing on the work of my hands. You are the One who gives me the power to work. Command the blessing into everything I put my hand to, as You did for Joseph in a stranger's house. Teach me for my profit, and lead me in the way I should go. Let me deal honestly, price fairly and speak the truth. Let the graciousness of the Lord our God be upon us, and establish the work of our hands; yes, the work of our hands, establish it. Amen." Then, and only then, open it and count.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

Don't count first and pray after. Pray first, then count, and whatever the number is, say thank You.

Honest weights

A blessing on the work of your hands goes together with honest work. Blessing and honesty belong together. If you sell something, describe it truly. If you charge for a service, charge what is fair. If you work for an employer, give a full hour for an hour's pay.

This is not only right; it is the ground the blessing grows in. Joseph's master saw that Hashem was with him. People can see it in you too, when your work is honest and your word is good.

Work at home is work

Not every reader has a paycheck. Some care for a spouse, a grandchild or a house. That is work of the hands too, and Psalm 90 asks Hashem to establish all of it. Before you start the day's tasks, say a word of the prayer below. Before you look at the household account, pray first. The teaching of Taanit 8b applies to your kitchen table as much as to a farmer's threshing floor.

When the work is slow

Some months the work dries up. Customers stop calling. Hours are cut. On those days, keep doing what you can: show up, do good work, keep your word, keep learning. Joseph was faithful in a slave's job and again in a prison. The Torah says the LORD was with him in both places.

Keep your prayer before counting even when the count will be small. Especially then.

STEP BY STEP

1. Choose the moment you will "measure" your work: opening the register, checking the account, counting the week's pay.
2. Say the prayer above before that moment, every time, this week.
3. Do not check the account or count the money until you have prayed.
4. Read Deuteronomy 8:17-18 once a week, so you never forget who gives the power.
5. Ask Hashem one specific question about your work before you sleep, using Isaiah 48:17.
6. Keep one promise to a customer or employer this week that costs you something.

BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

- [ ] I have read Deuteronomy 8:17-18, Deuteronomy 28:8, Genesis 39:2-3, Psalm 90:17 and Isaiah 48:17.
- [ ] I know the teaching of Taanit 8b: pray before you measure.

- [ ] I have chosen my "measuring" moment.
- [ ] I have prayed before counting at least once.
- [ ] I remember who gives the power to get wealth.



PART THREE

The Shield

Some of what we lose is not lost to bad luck or to bad choices, but to envy, our own and other people's, and to the habit of putting every blessing on display. In this part you will learn what the Sages actually said about the evil eye, the shield words of Joseph that the Talmud gives, and a simple way of living that keeps the blessing out of sight so it can grow.

CHAPTER 14

What the Sages Said About the Evil Eye

You finally get a little ahead. A bill is paid early, a check comes in, a grandchild lands a job. Then you tell the wrong person, you see the look on their face, and for days you can't shake the feeling that something just slipped away from you.

That feeling has a name in the Jewish tradition. It is called the evil eye, *ayin hara* in Hebrew. This chapter is about what the Sages really taught about it. Not the scary stories, not the lists of warning signs, but the plain teaching you can live by.

What the evil eye is, and what it is not

Many people hear "evil eye" and think of curses, spells, and someone across town wishing you harm. The Sages speak about it in a calmer and far more useful way.

In the tradition, the evil eye is the harm that comes from envy. It works in two directions. There is the envy other people feel when they look at what you have. And there is the envy you feel when you look at what they have. Both are "eyes" that look and are not glad.

There is a third piece, and it is the one we control most. It is showing off. When a blessing is put on display, it draws the eye. When it is kept quiet and modest, it rests.

So the teaching is not "be afraid." The teaching is: guard what you show, and guard how you look at others. The cure begins with your own good eye.

Rabbi Yehoshua's warning

The Mishnah, in Pirkei Avot, chapter 2, teaching 11, records the words of Rabbi Yehoshua. He said that three things take a person out of the world: the evil eye, the evil inclination, and hatred of other people.

Look at the company the evil eye keeps in that list. It sits next to the evil inclination, the pull inside us toward what is wrong. It sits next to hatred of people. All three are things that live inside a person.

That tells you where Rabbi Yehoshua looked first. Not at the neighbor. At the heart. An eye that cannot bear to see someone else do well slowly eats the one who owns it. It steals his peace, his sleep, and his joy in his own portion.

> **WHY THE SAGES PAIRED THE EYE WITH THE HEART**
> In the Mishnah, the "eye" is often a way of speaking about a person's attitude toward others. A "good eye" means generous, glad for others, quick to give. An "evil eye" means stingy, resentful, counting what the other person got. That is why the evil eye appears in Pirkei Avot next to the evil inclination and hatred: it is first a matter of character, before it is anything else.

Rav's teaching on the verse in Deuteronomy

The Talmud, in tractate Bava Metzia, page 107b, brings a teaching of Rav, one of the great Sages of Babylonia. He looked at the verse in Deuteronomy 7:15, where Moses promises that the LORD will take away from Israel all sickness. Rav read that "sickness" as the evil eye.

Then Rav said something strong. He taught that of a hundred people, ninety-nine die because of the evil eye, and only one by the ordinary way of the world.

Read that as Rav meant it: as a teaching, not a count taken in a hospital. Rav was not handing us a statistic. He was telling his students how deep this goes. Envy, comparison, and display wear people down far more than we admit. The worry about what others have, the strain of keeping up, the bitterness of being looked down on, the fear of being envied: all of this is heavy. Rav wanted his listeners to take it seriously.

And notice where Rav found the evil eye. In a verse of promise. The LORD will take it away. The teaching ends in hope, not in dread.

The wall and the fence

One page earlier, in Bava Metzia 107a, Rav teaches that a person should not stand by his neighbor's field when the grain is ripe and ready, because his eye could harm it. And on 107b the Talmud adds that a wall and a fence around the field keep it safe from the eye of passers-by.

This is one of the most practical teachings in the whole subject. The Sages did not tell the farmer to hang a charm on his gate. They told him to put up a wall. Make the crop less visible. Let people pass by without staring at your harvest.

Your "field" today is not usually wheat. It is your bank balance, your new car, your raise, your children's success, the inheritance that came in, the price you got for the house. The wall and the fence are the same idea: not everything needs to be seen.

There is a second lesson in the same teaching. Don't stand and stare at someone else's field. If you are the one passing by, keep walking. Be glad for them, and look away.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

I am not asking you to hide from people or to stop loving them. I am asking you to build a small wall around what Hashem gave you, and to keep your own eyes kind when you pass your neighbor's field.

Joshua and the children of Joseph

The Talmud, in tractate Bava Batra, pages 118a and 118b, tells about the time the land was divided. The descendants of Joseph came to Joshua and complained. They were a large tribe, they said, and their portion was too small.

Joshua's answer, as the Sages read it, was surprising. Go up into the forest, he told them, and hide yourselves there, so that the evil eye will not rule over you. You are many and you are blessed. Don't parade it. Go where the trees cover you.

The Sages took a lesson from this, and the next chapter builds on it. First, a person should guard himself against the evil eye, even a person from a blessed family. Second, Joseph's own line is where the tradition finds the shield against it. We will come to that in the next chapter.

For now, hold on to Joshua's word: when you are blessed, go into the forest. Let the trees cover you. It is not shame. It is wisdom.

The cure begins with your own eye

If you remember only one thing from this chapter, let it be this. The first protection from the evil eye is to have a good eye yourself.

Ask yourself three honest questions this week.

When a friend tells you good news about money, is your first feeling gladness or a quiet sting? When you scroll past someone's vacation or new kitchen, do you bless them in your heart or measure your life against theirs? When you have good news, do you share it to give joy, or to be seen?

Nobody answers all three perfectly. But the person who catches the sting and turns it into a blessing has already begun to heal. You can say it simply, under your breath: "May Hashem give them more, and may He give me my portion too." That small sentence turns an evil eye into a good one.

What this teaching does not ask of you

You do not need to suspect your sister-in-law. You do not need to search your life for signs that someone cursed you. You do not need to live in fear every time a stranger compliments your coat.

The Sages gave a measured teaching. Envy is real and it does harm. Showing off invites it. A modest life, a generous heart, and a few words of trust keep it away. That is all. Anything that makes you more afraid and less kind is not the teaching of the Sages.

In the coming chapters you will receive the shield words the Talmud gives, and a daily routine to keep the blessing hidden. Both rest on what you learned here.

CHECKLIST

- [ ] I can explain the evil eye in one sentence: the harm that comes from envy and from showing off.

- [ ] I read Rabbi Yehoshua's warning in Pirkei Avot 2:11 and looked first at my own heart.
- [ ] I understand Rav's teaching in Bava Metzia 107b as a teaching, not a statistic.
- [ ] I chose one "wall and fence" for my own field this week.
- [ ] I remember Joshua's word to Joseph's children: when you are blessed, go into the forest.
- [ ] I practiced turning a sting of envy into a blessing for someone else.

CHAPTER 15

The Seed of Joseph

You are about to walk into a room where money will be talked about. The bank. The lawyer. A family dinner where someone always asks what you paid for the house. Your stomach tightens before you even open the door.

The Talmud gives a short practice for that moment. It takes less than a minute, it uses your two hands and one verse, and it comes from the blessing that Jacob gave his son Joseph.

Jacob's blessing over Joseph

At the end of the book of Genesis, Jacob is old and near death. He calls his sons and blesses each one. When he comes to Joseph, he speaks of a vine.

> *Joseph is a fruitful vine, A fruitful vine by a fountain; Its branches run over the wall. (Genesis 49:22)*

בֵּן פֹּרָת יוֹסֵף בֵּן פֹּרָת עֲלֵי־עָיִן

ben po-RAT yo-SEF, ben po-RAT a-LEI A-yin

Joseph is a fruitful vine, a fruitful vine by a fountain.

Picture it. A vine planted by a spring. It drinks all day, so it never dries out. It grows so strong that its branches climb up and over the wall. That is Joseph: sold as a slave, thrown into prison, and still he grew, still he gave fruit, still he climbed over every wall put in front of him.



"A fruitful vine by a fountain; its branches run over the wall."

The word "ayin" has two meanings

In Hebrew, the word *ayin* means a spring of water. It also means an eye. The same word.

So when Jacob says Joseph is a vine *alei ayin*, the plain meaning is "by a fountain," next to the spring. But the Sages heard the second meaning too. They heard the eye.

Rabbi Yochanan's answer

The Talmud, in tractate Berakhot, page 20a, tells about Rabbi Yochanan, one of the great Sages of the Land of Israel. He was asked: aren't you afraid of the evil eye?

Rabbi Yochanan answered that he came from the seed of Joseph, and the evil eye has no power over Joseph's seed. He quoted the verse you just read: Joseph is a fruitful vine, a fruitful vine *alei ayin*.

Then Rabbi Abbahu added a reading. Don't read it as *alei ayin*, "by the spring," he said. Read it as *olei ayin*, "rising above the eye." Joseph and his children rise above the eye. Its look cannot reach them.

> **THE PLAY ON THE HEBREW**
> *Alei ayin* and *olei ayin* are written with almost the same letters. The Sages often read a verse two ways like this, keeping the plain meaning and drawing out a second lesson. Rabbi Abbahu did not erase "by the fountain." He showed that the same words also say "above the eye."

The fish under the water

On the same page, Rabbi Yosei bar Chanina gave another proof. He pointed to the blessing Jacob gave Joseph's two sons, Ephraim and Manasseh, in Genesis 48:16. There Jacob prays that they will grow into a multitude, and the Hebrew word he uses, *ve-yidgu*, comes from the word for fish.

Rabbi Yosei bar Chanina explained: just as fish in the sea are covered by water, and the eye cannot reach them, so the children of Joseph are covered, and the evil eye cannot reach them.

Think about that picture. The fish are not fighting anyone. They are not hiding in fear. They are simply living in their element, under the surface, out of sight. That is the kind of protection the Sages describe. Not a weapon. A covering.

Joseph's eye did not take what was not his

The Talmud gives one more reason, and it is the most important for us. Joseph's own eye did not want what was not his. When the wife of his master Potiphar tried to take him, Joseph refused. His eye did not reach for what belonged to another man.

So the Sages taught: the eye that would not take what was not his is protected from the eye of others.

Here is the heart of the shield. Joseph is protected from the evil eye because he did not have one. His eye was clean. When you say "I am of the seed of Joseph," you are not only claiming his protection. You are promising to live like him: to be glad with your own portion and not reach for your neighbor's.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

Before you say Joseph's words, check your own eye. If you are walking into that room hoping to get the better of someone, fix that first. Then the words will sit right in your mouth.

The practice from Berakhot 55b

The Talmud, in tractate Berakhot, page 55b, gives the practice itself. A person who comes into a town and is afraid of the evil eye should take the thumb of his right hand in his left hand, and the thumb of his left hand in his right hand, and say: "I, so-and-so son of so-and-so, am of the seed of Joseph, over whom the evil eye has no power." Then he says the verse, Joseph is a fruitful vine, a fruitful vine by a fountain.

That is the whole practice. Two thumbs, one sentence, one verse.



The grip from Berakhot 55b: each hand holds the other's thumb.

STEP BY STEP

1. Stop before the door. Stand still for a moment and breathe.
2. Take your right thumb inside your left hand.

3. Take your left thumb inside your right hand, so your two hands hold each other.
4. Say the shield words slowly, with your own name and your parent's name.
5. Say Genesis 49:22, in Hebrew if you can, or in English.
6. Let go of your hands, and walk in with a good eye.

THE SHIELD WORDS

Hold your thumbs as the Talmud teaches. Say: "I, [your name], son of [your father's or mother's name] (or daughter of), am of the seed of Joseph, over whom the evil eye has no power." Then say: "Joseph is a fruitful vine, a fruitful vine by a fountain." Or in Hebrew: "Ben po-RAT yo-SEF, ben po-RAT a-LEI A-yin."

A few plain questions people ask.

What if I am not descended from Joseph? The Talmud gives the words to anyone who fears the evil eye, not only to someone who has traced his family tree. You are taking Joseph's name as your covering and his way as your way.

Which parent's name? The Talmud's wording is simply "so-and-so son of so-and-so." Use the name you are used to saying in prayer. Many people say their mother's name; others say their father's. Choose one and keep it.

Do I need to say it out loud? A quiet voice is enough. Nobody in the parking lot needs to hear you.

How this program uses it

Be clear about one thing. The Talmud gives this practice for a person entering a town who is afraid of the evil eye. That is its setting in Berakhot 55b.

This program takes the same practice into the places where money and envy meet in your life today. It is the program's own use, built on the Talmud's practice. Say the shield words in your car before you walk into the bank. Before the doctor's office,

when you are anxious about what the visit will cost. Before a family gathering where someone always talks about money, who got what, who earns what. Before you sign papers on a house. Before a meeting at work about your pay.

Each of those is a kind of "entering a town." You are walking into a place where eyes will be on what you have. You hold your thumbs, you say Joseph's words, and you go in covered, like the fish under the water.

The blessing that closes the shield

After the shield words, close with the blessing the priests gave Israel. Hashem told Aaron and his sons to bless the people with these words, and they are said in synagogues to this day.

> *The LORD bless thee, and keep thee; The LORD make His face to shine upon thee, and be gracious unto thee; The LORD lift up His countenance upon thee, and give thee peace. (Numbers 6:24-26)*

יְבָרֶכְךָ יְהוָה וְיִשְׁמְרֶךָ

ye-va-re-che-CHA Adonai ve-yish-me-RE-cha

The LORD bless you and keep you.

"Keep thee" is the word for guarding. You asked for Joseph's covering; now you ask Hashem Himself to keep you. You can say the whole blessing in English, slowly, or only its first line in Hebrew. Either way, you end not with fear of eyes but with the face of Hashem shining on you.

CHECKLIST

- [ ] I read Genesis 49:22 and can say "ben po-RAT yo-SEF, ben po-RAT a-LEI A-yin."
- [ ] I know the two meanings of *ayin*: spring and eye.
- [ ] I know the three teachings of Berakhot 20a: above the eye, the fish under the water, and Joseph's clean eye.
- [ ] I practiced the thumb grip from Berakhot 55b at home.

- [ ] I said the shield words with my own name and my parent's name.
- [ ] I chose one place this week (bank, doctor, family table) where I will use the shield.
- [ ] I closed with the priestly blessing of Numbers 6:24-26.

CHAPTER 16

Living Hidden: Keep the Blessing Out of Sight

You count your money on the kitchen table while your nephew watches. You tell the neighbor about the refund. You post a photo of the new car. None of it feels like a mistake at the time.

The Sages taught that blessing grows best where the eye does not reach. This chapter turns that teaching into habits you can keep every day, from the way you count to the way you give.

Blessing rests on what is hidden

The Talmud, in tractate Taanit, page 8b, teaches about a farmer who goes to measure the grain on his threshing floor. Before he measures, he should pray: may it be Your will, LORD our God, that You send blessing on the work of our hands.

Once he has begun measuring, the Sages said, he should say: blessed is the One who sends blessing on this pile. But if he measured first and only then prayed, his prayer is a prayer in vain. Why? Because blessing is not found in something that has already been weighed, measured, or counted. Blessing is found only in what is hidden from the eye.

Two lessons come out of this short teaching. First, pray before you count. Second, don't keep counting in the open. What is counted is fixed; what is covered can still grow.

A FARMER'S TEACHING FOR A MODERN KITCHEN

The Sages were speaking to farmers measuring grain, but the rule is about anything we count: wages, savings, a pension check, the cash in an envelope. The point is not that numbers are bad. You still pay your bills and keep your records. The point is to bring Hashem in before the number, and to keep the counting private.

Pray before you open the envelope

Here is how the teaching of Taanit 8b becomes a daily habit.

Before you open your bank app, before you look at the pension deposit, before you count the cash at the end of the week, stop for one breath. Say: "May it be Your will, Hashem, to send blessing on the work of my hands." Then look.

It is a small thing. But it changes the order. The number no longer comes first. Hashem comes first, and the number comes after, as His gift.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

Don't let the bank balance be the first prayer you say in the morning. Say His name, then look at the numbers. And when you are done, close the app and put it away.

Don't announce it, don't count it aloud, don't post it

Taanit 8b and the wall around the field in Bava Metzia 107a-b point the same way. Keep the blessing out of sight. In daily life, that comes down to a few plain habits.

Don't announce money. When something good comes in, a raise, a refund, an inheritance, a good price on a sale, you don't need to tell everyone. Tell your spouse. Tell the person who needs to know. Thank Hashem. Let the rest of the world find out later, or never.

Don't count it aloud in front of others. Count cash in a private room, not at the family table or the store counter. Don't recite your balance on the phone in a waiting room. What others hear, they measure.

Don't post it. A photo of the new kitchen, the cruise, the check, the keys to the new car, goes in front of hundreds of eyes in a moment. Some of them are glad for you. Some of them are not. The Sages told the farmer to build a wall. A phone with no post on it is a wall.

Don't talk about what others have, either. Living hidden goes both ways. Don't ask people what they paid, what they earn, what they inherited. Let their field stay behind their wall too.



What is kept out of sight can keep growing.

Give quietly

The quietest money is the money you give away. Here too, the tradition asks you to keep it out of sight. When you give tzedakah, as you did in the first seven days, give it without an audience. Don't mention the amount. Don't let it become a story you tell.

Quiet giving protects both sides. The one who receives keeps his dignity. And you keep your gift clean of pride, which is a small cousin of showing off.

The good eye of Abraham

The Mishnah, in Pirkei Avot, chapter 5, teaching 19, describes the students of our father Abraham. They have three marks: a good eye, a humble spirit, and a modest appetite. The students of Bilaam, the prophet who was hired to curse Israel, have the opposite: an evil eye, a proud spirit, and a greedy appetite.

And the Mishnah says what each one receives. The students of Abraham enjoy this world and inherit the World to Come. That is a beautiful promise. The good eye is not only a way to be safe. It is a way to enjoy what you have here, now, at your own table.

Look at the order of Abraham's three marks. The good eye comes first. Before humility, before restraint, comes the eye that is glad for others.

The bountiful eye

The book of Proverbs puts the good eye into one verse.

> *He that hath a bountiful eye shall be blessed; For he giveth of his bread to the poor. (Proverbs 22:9)*

טוֹב־עַיִן הוּא יְבֹרָךְ׃

TOV A-yin hu ye-vo-RACH

The one with a good eye will be blessed.

The English says "bountiful eye." The Hebrew says *tov ayin*, a good eye, the exact opposite of *ayin hara*, the evil eye. And notice what makes the eye good: he gives of his bread to the poor. The good eye is not a feeling only. It shows up as bread on someone else's table.

So here is the full cure for the evil eye, in the words of Scripture. Not a charm. A generous eye, and a hand that gives. That person "shall be blessed."

Proverbs says it once more in another place.

> *The beneficent soul shall be made rich, and he that satisfieth abundantly shall be satisfied also himself. (Proverbs 11:25)*

The one who satisfies others is satisfied himself. The good eye looks outward, and the blessing comes back around.

A daily shield routine

Here is how the whole of this part fits into one day. It takes a few minutes in total. It does not replace your morning reading from the program; it sits beside it.

STEP BY STEP

1. **Morning, on waking:** before you look at your phone or your money, say a short thank-you to Hashem. Then, if you will check a balance today, say first: "May it be Your will, Hashem, to send blessing on the work of my hands."
2. **Morning, before you leave the house:** stand by the door. Hold your thumbs as Berakhot 55b teaches and say the shield words: "I, [your name], son (or daughter) of [your parent's name], am of the seed of Joseph, over whom the evil eye has no power," and Genesis 49:22.
3. **Before any room where money is spoken of:** the bank, the doctor's office, the lawyer, a family gathering. Hold your thumbs again and say the shield words. Close with "The LORD bless thee, and keep thee."
4. **During the day:** when good news comes, thank Hashem and keep it to yourself and the people who need to know. When you hear someone else's good news, bless them in your heart: "May Hashem give them more."
5. **During the day:** give one quiet gift, even a small coin in the tzedakah box, with no one watching.
6. **Night, before sleep:** put away the wallet, the envelope, and the phone. Say the priestly blessing of Numbers 6:24-26 over yourself and your family. Ask yourself one question: "Was my eye good today?" Write the answer in your Promise Notebook.

If you miss a step, don't start over. Pick it up at the next door you walk through.

Why hiddenness is not fear

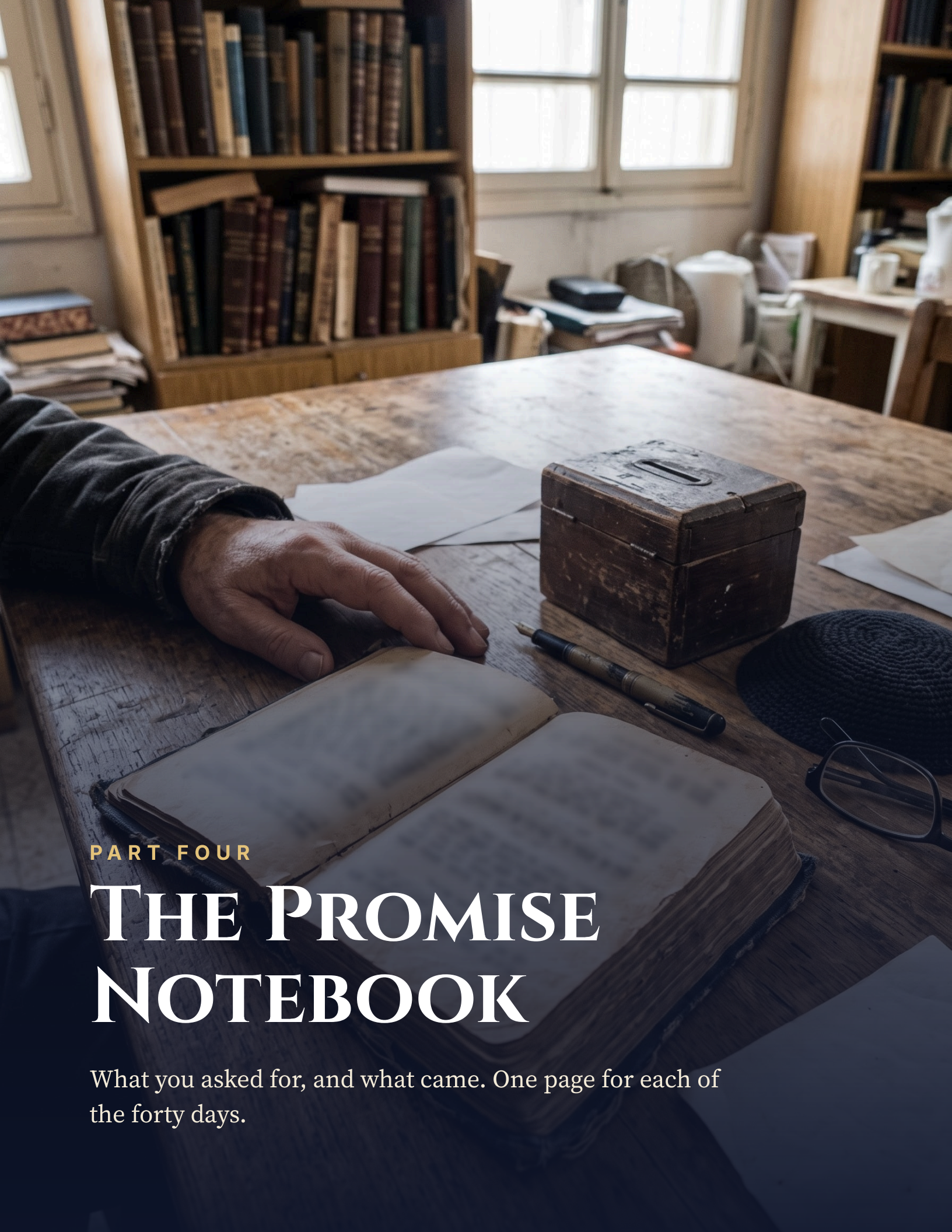
Some readers worry that living hidden means living small, or living afraid. It is the opposite.

The farmer in Taanit 8b still harvests his field. Joseph still rules over Egypt. The children of Joseph are still a great tribe. The fish still fill the sea. Nothing in these teachings asks you to have less. They ask you to hold what you have with a quiet hand and a good eye, so it can keep growing where the eye does not reach.

That is the shield. A wall around the field, Joseph's words at the door, the counting done in private, the giving done in secret, and an eye that is glad for everyone else. Live that way for the rest of the forty days, and see how much lighter you feel.

BEFORE YOU MOVE ON

- [ ] I know the teaching of Taanit 8b: blessing rests on what is hidden from the eye.
- [ ] I say "send blessing on the work of my hands" before I look at a balance or count money.
- [ ] I stopped announcing, counting aloud, and posting what I have.
- [ ] I stopped asking others what they paid or earned.
- [ ] I gave at least one gift quietly this week.
- [ ] I know Abraham's three marks from Pirkei Avot 5:19, with the good eye first.
- [ ] I can say "TOV A-yin hu ye-vo-RACH" from Proverbs 22:9.
- [ ] I have followed the daily shield routine for at least one full day.
- [ ] At night I asked, "Was my eye good today?" and wrote the answer in my Promise Notebook.



PART FOUR

The Promise Notebook

What you asked for, and what came. One page for each of the forty days.

How to Keep the Notebook

Each evening, before you sleep, open to the page of the day. Write one line about what you asked Hashem for. Then write what came, big or small: a payment that cleared, a call that went well, a kind word, a bill that was smaller than you feared. Write it even if it seems like nothing.

The Sages taught that blessing rests on what is hidden from the eye (Taanit 8b). So this notebook is for you alone. Don't show it, don't count it out loud, and don't post it. Keep it in a drawer.

On Day 40, read every page from the first. Most people are surprised by how much they wrote in the second column.



RABBI DAVID'S WORD

If a day has nothing in the second line, write "I am still here, and I still trust." That counts too.

DAY 1

Today's reading

Psalm 112

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 2

Today's reading

Psalm 65

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 3

Today's reading

Psalm 23

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 4

Today's reading

Psalm 91

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 5

Today's reading

Psalm 24

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 6

Today's reading

Psalm 145

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 7

Today's reading

Psalm 37:25

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 8

Today's reading

Psalm 145:15-16

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 9

Today's reading

Psalm 104:27-28

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 10

Today's reading

Psalm 136:1, 25

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 11

Today's reading

Psalm 34:10-11

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 12

Today's reading

Psalm 55:23

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 13

Today's reading

Psalm 37:3-5

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 14

Today's reading

Psalm 16:5

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 15

Today's reading
Exodus 16:4

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 16

Today's reading

Exodus 16:16–18

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 17

Today's reading

Exodus 16:19-20

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 18

Today's reading

Exodus 16:22–26

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 19

Today's reading

Exodus 16:35

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

- [ ] Morning reading
- [ ] Midday minute
- [ ] Night

DAY 20

Today's reading

Deuteronomy 8:3

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 21

Today's reading

Deuteronomy 8:17–18

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 22

Today's reading

Genesis 49:22

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 23

Today's reading

Numbers 6:24-26

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 24

Today's reading

Psalm 121:7-8

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 25

Today's reading

Psalm 127:1-2

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 26

Today's reading

Proverbs 13:11

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 27

Today's reading

Proverbs 10:22

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 28

Today's reading

Proverbs 22:9

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 29

Today's reading

Deuteronomy 28:8

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 30

Today's reading

Deuteronomy 28:12

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 31

Today's reading

Psalm 90:17

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 32

Today's reading

Psalm 128:1-2

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 33

Today's reading

Genesis 39:2-3

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 34

Today's reading

Malachi 3:10

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 35

Today's reading
Isaiah 48:17

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 36

Today's reading

Exodus 24:18

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 37

Today's reading

1 Kings 17:14-16

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 38

Today's reading

2 Kings 4:2-6

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 39

Today's reading

Psalm 67

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

DAY 40

Today's reading

Psalm 100

Date: _____

WHAT I ASKED HASHEM FOR TODAY

WHAT CAME TODAY (BIG OR SMALL)

TZEDAKAH I GAVE, QUIETLY

A WORD I HELD BACK

☐ Morning reading ☐ Midday minute ☐ Night

Your Wallet Card

Cut out one card along the dashed line, fold it on the middle so the verse is on one side and the Hebrew on the other, and keep it where you keep your money. Read it every time you open your wallet. There are three, so you can give one to someone you love.

THE COVENANT OF PROVISION · KEEP IN YOUR WALLET

"Wealth gotten by vanity shall be diminished; But he that gathereth little by little shall increase."

Proverbs 13:11

הוֹן מֵהֶבֶל יִמְעָט וְקֹבֵץ עַל יָד יַרְבֶּה

HON me-**HE**-vel yim-**AT**, ve-ko-**VETZ**
al **YAD** yar-**BEH**

My name: _____ Started on Day 1: _____

THE COVENANT OF PROVISION · KEEP IN YOUR WALLET

"Wealth gotten by vanity shall be diminished; But he that gathereth little by little shall increase."

Proverbs 13:11

הוֹן מֵהֶבֶל יִמְעָט וְקֹבֵץ עַל יָד יַרְבֶּה

HON me-**HE**-vel yim-**AT**, ve-ko-**VETZ**
al **YAD** yar-**BEH**

My name: _____ Started on Day 1: _____

THE COVENANT OF PROVISION · KEEP IN YOUR WALLET

"Wealth gotten by vanity shall be diminished; But he that gathereth little by little shall increase."

Proverbs 13:11

הוֹן מֵהֶבֶל יִמְעָט וְקֹבֵץ עַל יָד יַרְבֶּה

HON me-**HE**-vel yim-**AT**, ve-ko-**VETZ**
al **YAD** yar-**BEH**

My name: _____ Started on Day 1: _____

✂ Cut along the dashed lines. Fold each pair so the dark side and the light side face out.

How to Read the Hebrew

Every Hebrew box in this book gives you three lines: the Hebrew letters, a "say" line, and the meaning. You do not need to read Hebrew letters to use this book. The "say" line is written so that an English reader can speak the words out loud, slowly, the first time.

The rules of the "say" line

Syllables are split with hyphens. Read each piece separately, then run them together. *ye-hav-CHA* is three small sounds: ye, hav, cha.

The capital letters show the stress. The syllable in CAPITALS is the one you lean on, a little louder and a little longer. In *ba-BA-yit* (house), you say "ba-BAH-yit." Most Hebrew words are stressed on the last syllable, but not all, so follow the capitals.

ch is a sound from the throat. It is not the "ch" of "church." It is the sound at the end of the composer's name "Bach," or of the Scottish "loch." Breathe it out from the back of the throat. *Beracha* is "be-ra-CHAH" with that soft rasp.

tz sounds like "ts," as at the end of "cats." *Tzedakah* begins "tse."

The mark ' is a short stop, a tiny break in the breath between two sounds, like the catch in "uh-oh."

Vowels are simple and steady. *a* as in "father," *e* as in "bed," *i* as in "machine," *o* as in "more," *u* as in "rule." The short *e* at the start of many words (*ve-*, *le-*, *be-*) is said very quickly, almost swallowed.

The Name. Where the Hebrew letters show the holy four-letter Name, the "say" line writes *Adonai*, which is how it is read in prayer. In everyday speech, outside of prayer, many people say *Hashem*, "the Name."

Pronunciation. This book uses the Sephardic and modern Israeli way of speaking Hebrew, which is the one you will hear most often today: *Shabbat*, not *Shabbos*.

If you stumble, that is fine. Hashem hears the heart before the accent. Say it slowly, and say it again tomorrow.

Key words used in this book

Word	Say it	Meaning
Adonai	a-do-NAI	"My Lord"; how the holy Name is read in prayer
Hashem	ha-SHEM	"The Name"; how many people refer to God outside prayer
parnasah	par-na-SAH	Livelihood, sustenance, the means to live
tzedakah	tze-da-KAH	Charity; literally "righteousness," giving what is right
beracha	be-ra-CHAH	Blessing
ayin hara	A-yin ha-RA	The evil eye: envy, a hostile or begrudging look
emunah	e-mu-NAH	Faith; firm belief in Hashem
bitachon	bi-ta-CHON	Trust; relying on Hashem in practice
man	MAN	Manna, the bread from heaven in the wilderness
Tehillim	te-hi-LIM	The Book of Psalms

Where Every Verse Comes From

All Bible quotations in this book are from the Jewish Publication Society translation of 1917. Verse numbers follow the Hebrew Bible; in some English Bibles a Psalm verse number can be one lower. Teachings from the Talmud and the codes are given in this book in plain words of our own, with their source named.

The readings of days 8 to 40

Day	Reference	First words (JPS)
8	Psalm 145:15-16	"The eyes of all wait for Thee..."
9	Psalm 104:27-28	"All of them wait for Thee..."
10	Psalm 136:1, 136:25	"O give thanks unto the LORD, for He is good..."
11	Psalm 34:10-11	"O fear the LORD, ye His holy ones..."
12	Psalm 55:23	"Cast thy burden upon the LORD..."
13	Psalm 37:3-5	"Trust in the LORD, and do good..."
14	Psalm 16:5; Talmud, Sotah 48b; Mishnah, Avot 4:1	"O LORD, the portion of mine inheritance..."
15	Exodus 16:4	"Then said the LORD unto Moses: 'Behold, I will cause to rain bread from heaven...'"
16	Exodus 16:16-18	"This is the thing which the LORD hath commanded..."
17	Exodus 16:19-20	"And Moses said unto them: 'Let no man leave of it till the morning.'"
18	Exodus 16:22-26	"And it came to pass that on the sixth day..."
19	Exodus 16:35; Talmud, Yoma 76a	"And the children of Israel did eat the manna forty years..."
20	Deuteronomy 8:3	"And He afflicted thee, and suffered thee to hunger..."
21	Deuteronomy 8:17-18	"and thou say in thy heart: 'My power and the might of my hand...'"

Day	Reference	First words (JPS)
22	Genesis 49:22	"Joseph is a fruitful vine..."
23	Numbers 6:24-26	"The LORD bless thee, and keep thee..."
24	Psalm 121:7-8	"The LORD shall keep thee from all evil..."
25	Psalm 127:1-2	"Except the LORD build the house..."
26	Proverbs 13:11	"Wealth gotten by vanity shall be diminished..."
27	Proverbs 10:22	"The blessing of the LORD, it maketh rich..."
28	Proverbs 22:9; Mishnah, Avot 5:19	"He that hath a bountiful eye shall be blessed..."
29	Deuteronomy 28:8	"The LORD will command the blessing with thee..."
30	Deuteronomy 28:12	"The LORD will open unto thee His good treasure..."
31	Psalm 90:17	"And let the graciousness of the Lord our God be upon us..."
32	Psalm 128:1-2	"A Song of Ascents. Happy is every one that feareth the LORD..."
33	Genesis 39:2-3	"And the LORD was with Joseph..."
34	Malachi 3:10; Talmud, Taanit 9a	"Bring ye the whole tithe into the store-house..."
35	Isaiah 48:17	"Thus saith the LORD, thy Redeemer..."
36	Exodus 24:18	"And Moses entered into the midst of the cloud..."
37	1 Kings 17:14-16	"For thus saith the LORD, the God of Israel: The jar of meal shall not be spent..."
38	2 Kings 4:2-6	"And Elisha said unto her: 'What shall I do for thee?...'"
39	Psalm 67:6-7	"Let the peoples give thanks unto Thee, O God..."
40	Psalm 100	"A Psalm of thanksgiving. Shout unto the LORD, all the earth."

The verses of chapters 8 to 13

Chapter	Reference	First words (JPS)
8	2 Kings 4:1-7	"Now there cried a certain woman of the wives of the sons of the prophets..."
8	Proverbs 22:7	"The rich ruleth over the poor..."

Chapter	Reference	First words (JPS)
8	Deuteronomy 28:12	"The LORD will open unto thee His good treasure..."
9	Psalm 46:2	"God is our refuge and strength..."
9	Psalm 121:1-2	"A Song of Ascents. I will lift up mine eyes unto the mountains..."
9	Psalm 55:23	"Cast thy burden upon the LORD..."
9	1 Kings 17:12-16	"And she said: 'As the LORD thy God liveth, I have not a cake...'"
10	Psalm 127:1-2	"Except the LORD build the house..."
10	Proverbs 24:3-4	"Through wisdom is a house builded..."
10	Deuteronomy 6:9	"And thou shalt write them upon the door-posts of thy house..."
10	Psalm 121:8	"The LORD shall guard thy going out and thy coming in..."
10	Talmud, Bava Metzia 59a	Teaching of Rabbi Helbo and Rava on honor in the home
11	Genesis 48:20	"And he blessed them that day, saying..."
11	Isaiah 54:13	"And all thy children shall be taught of the LORD..."
11	Proverbs 13:22	"A good man leaveth an inheritance to his children's children..."
12	Psalm 71:9	"Cast me not off in the time of old age..."
12	Psalm 71:18	"And even unto old age and hoary hairs, O God, forsake me not..."
12	Psalm 92:13-16	"The righteous shall flourish like the palm-tree..."
12	Isaiah 46:4	"Even to old age I am the same..."
12	Talmud, Sotah 48b; Ketubot 50a; Shulchan Aruch, Yoreh De'ah 249:1; Mishnah, Avot 4:1	Teachings on trust for tomorrow, the limits of giving, and gladness with one's portion
13	Deuteronomy 8:17-18	"and thou say in thy heart: 'My power and the might of my hand...'"
13	Deuteronomy 28:8	"The LORD will command the blessing with thee..."

Chapter	Reference	First words (JPS)
13	Genesis 39:2-3	"And the LORD was with Joseph..."
13	Psalm 90:17	"And let the graciousness of the Lord our God be upon us..."
13	Isaiah 48:17	"Thus saith the LORD, thy Redeemer..."
13	Talmud, Taanit 8b	Teaching on praying for blessing before measuring

A Last Word

You have walked forty days with me. You opened your hand, you gathered bread one day at a time, you guarded the gate, you blessed the work of your hands, and you climbed the mountain. Some days were easy and some were not. You kept going, and that is what matters.

I don't know what your bills look like tonight. I don't know what your account says or what worry sits on your chest when you lie down. Hashem knows. He knew before you opened this book, and He will know long after you close it. He opens His hand to every living thing, and you are one of them.

So before you go, let me do what the priests of Israel were told to do. Let me bless you with the words Hashem Himself gave them:

> *The LORD bless thee, and keep thee;*
> *The LORD make His face to shine upon thee, and be gracious unto thee;*
> *The LORD lift up His countenance upon thee, and give thee peace. (Numbers 6:24-26)*

May He bless what you have and keep it. May His face shine on your house, on your table and on the work of your hands. May He be gracious to your children and to your children's children. And may He give you peace, the kind that lets you sleep.

Keep the morning. Keep giving, a little, with a good eye. Keep quiet about what grows. And whenever you need to, open this book again and start on any page.

Go in peace.

— Rabbi David